

AMAZON INDIA SELLER HANDBOOK

2026 Edition

A plain-English guide to fees, tax and compliance for selling on Amazon.in

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Fee data effective from Amazon's 16 March 2026 update

Every number in this book carries a confidence label. Some figures were read straight from Amazon's own rate cards and regulators' own pages. Others are widely published but could not be independently checked. A few only exist inside your logged-in account and no book can print them.

The labels tell you which is which, so you always know how much weight a number can bear.

Read Chapter 1 first — it explains the labels and lists the five things this market most commonly gets wrong.

The rule that overrides everything else: a number in Seller Central beats a number in this book. Amazon can change any fee at any time, and says so on its own fee page.

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1 • How Sure Is Each Number

Selling costs money in ways that are easy to get wrong, and most guides state everything with equal confidence. This book does not. Four labels appear throughout, and they are the most useful thing in here.

Label	What it means	What you should do
VERIFIED	Read directly from a named primary source on 4 August 2026 — Amazon's own rate cards and fee page, or a regulator's own document. The link is printed underneath.	Trust it. Re-check in about six months.
UNCONFIRMED	Widely published and probably correct, but not independently checked for this edition.	Confirm once before you rely on it for money.
CHECK LIVE	The real figure only exists inside your logged-in account, or changes per product. No book can print it.	Look it up yourself, every time.
UNSETTLED	Credible sources genuinely disagree and the question is not resolvable from public documents.	Get professional advice before acting.

What was verified for this edition

Amazon publishes its closing-fee and weight-handling rate cards as **images**, not text, which is why most guides either omit them or tell you to use a calculator. **Those images were located and read for this book.** The full tables are in Chapter 8 — closing fees for all four fulfilment channels and all price bands, and weight-handling rates broken down by STEP level.

Also verified line by line: the entire Home, Décor, Home Improvement, Furniture, Outdoor and Lawn & Garden referral fee section (40+ rows), the pick & pack, storage and removal fees, the GST treatment, and the STEP benefits table.

1.1 Five things this market commonly gets wrong

Each of these appears confidently stated in guides, videos and blog posts. Each is wrong, and each costs money.

#	The common claim	What is actually true	Why it matters
1	"TCS is 1% of your sales."	VERIFIED TCS is 0.5% — split 0.25% CGST + 0.25% SGST within your state, or 0.5% IGST across states. It was cut from 1% on 10 July 2024 .	The 1% figure is still repeated everywhere. Using it makes you hunt for a monthly mismatch on the GST portal that does not exist.
2	"There is no closing fee above ₹500. "	VERIFIED There is. On FBA it is ₹27 for ₹501–1,000 and ₹52 above ₹1,000 (₹72 for select categories). On Self-Ship it reaches ₹101 .	This one silently inflates your projected profit on every product priced above ₹500.
3	"Referral fee is 0% under ₹1,000. "	VERIFIED 0% under ₹1,000 in most categories — 1,800+ of them. Not all. Books, laptops, phones, mattresses under ₹500 and others still charge.	Taken literally it causes underpricing. Always check your own category.
4	"Long-term storage charges start at 271 or 365 days. "	VERIFIED The aged-inventory surcharge moved to 181 days on 16 January 2026 — 90 days earlier than before.	Plan a nine-month stock runway on the old number and surcharges hit three months before you budgeted for them.

#	The common claim	What is actually true	Why it matters
5	"Silver hallmarking became mandatory in September 2025."	VERIFIED Silver hallmarking is voluntary . A HUID-based voluntary system began 1 September 2025 under standard IS 2112:2025. BIS plans a phased move to mandatory with no date announced.	Only relevant if you enter jewellery — but it shows how confidently wrong this space can be.

And one thing almost nobody mentions at all

Your weight-handling fee depends on your STEP level. Amazon charges Basic-level sellers more than Standard, and Standard more than Advanced or Premium, for the exact same parcel. The difference is ₹3–₹6 per shipment. Almost no guide covers this because the rate card is an image. **You are on Standard** — see 8.9 for what that gets you and what moving up is worth.

1.2 The honest limits of this book

- **It cannot see your account.** Your fee category, your exact packed weight, your current STEP level and your account health targets all live behind a login. Anything depending on those is labelled **CHECK LIVE** and listed in Appendix H.
- **Fee tables go stale.** Amazon revised its India fee schedule at least twice in the last two years. Appendix A and B carry an effective date — check it against the live page before pricing anything new.
- **Regulators move without warning.** FSSAI rewrote its entire licence threshold structure on 1 April 2026 with no advance notice. Chapter 17 tells you which regulator applies to what; it cannot promise the thresholds have not moved since printing.
- **One question is left genuinely open** — whether EPR plastic packaging rules exempt micro and small brand owners. Credible sources conflict. See 17.5, and take it to a consultant rather than trusting either answer.

2 • One-Page Cheat Sheet

A memory aid, not a substitute for the chapters. Every number here is explained in full later.

Your profit on one sale =

Selling price

- what you paid for the product
- packaging
- freight to get it to Amazon
- referral fee (Amazon's commission)
- closing fee (flat fee per sale)
- weight handling fee (delivery)
- pick & pack fee (FBA only)
- storage fee (FBA only)
- 18% GST on all Amazon fees above
- advertising
- expected cost of returns

The numbers, for you specifically

FBA • dispatching from Telangana (Region 3) • **Standard STEP level**

Fee	Your number	Confidence	Section
Referral fee	0% up to ₹1,000 in most categories. Check yours — real exceptions exist.	VERIFIED	8.2
Closing fee (FBA)	₹0–300: ₹26 / ₹20 / ₹13 • ₹301–500: ₹22 / ₹18 / ₹14 (by category group)	VERIFIED	8.3
	₹501–1,000: ₹27 • above ₹1,000: ₹52 (₹72 select categories)	VERIFIED	8.3
Weight handling (FBA, standard size)	First 500 g: ₹39 Regional / ₹65 National. 500 g–1 kg: ₹54 / ₹85.	VERIFIED	8.4
Pick & pack (FBA)	₹17 standard up to 1 kg • ₹26 Heavy & Bulky	VERIFIED	8.5
Storage (FBA)	₹50 per cubic foot per month	VERIFIED	8.6
Aged inventory surcharge	Starts at 181 days	VERIFIED	8.6
GST on Amazon fees	18%, always, added on top of the fee	VERIFIED	8.8
TCS	0.5% withheld — refundable as credit, not a cost	VERIFIED	5.3
Getting paid	7 days after delivery, disbursed weekly (Standard level)	VERIFIED	3.2, 8.9

What Amazon takes on your ₹333 rope wire

Closing ₹18 + weight handling ₹39–₹85 + pick & pack ₹17, plus 18% GST on all of it. That is **₹87 to ₹142** depending on parcel weight and how far it ships — roughly **26% to 43% of your selling price** before you pay for the rope. Full working in Chapter 9.

Which rules apply to my product? — 60-second check

If your product is...	You need	Section
Electrical or electronic, or a toy with electronics	BIS registration (CRS)	17.1
Food, drink, or a supplement	FSSAI licence — online sellers reportedly need a Central licence whatever their turnover	17.2
A medical device, or makes a health claim	CDSCO licence	17.3
Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, or any wireless	WPC approval (self-declaration route usually)	17.4
Wrapped in plastic (poly bag, bubble wrap, shrink wrap)	EPR plastic — status unclear for micro/small	17.5
Containing any battery	EPR battery registration	17.6
Gold jewellery	Hallmarking + HUID (mandatory). Silver is voluntary.	17.7
Clothing or textiles	Legal Metrology, plus the loose-garment labelling rule	17.8
Imported from outside India	IEC from DGFT	17.9
Anything pre-packed at all	Legal Metrology labelling — no exceptions	7

The 12 steps, start to finish

Idea → Research (15) → Check it is legal (16) → Find supplier (18) → Order a sample (18) → Packaging & barcode (19) → Labelling (7) → Create listing (App G) → Send to FBA (8) → First reviews (4) → Advertising (21) → Scale (25)

3 · Read This First — Your Advertising Is Losing Money

Everything else in this book is reference material. This page is an emergency brake. It is based on your own Seller Central data on 4 August 2026.

The numbers

What your account shows	Figure	What it means
Sponsored Ads spend, last 7 days	₹1,858	About ₹7,960 a month at that rate
Sponsored Ads attributed sales, last 7 days	₹0	The spend produced no traceable sales at all
Units sold in July	32	So ads cost ₹249 per unit sold
July revenue	~₹10,656	Ads are 75% of revenue (TACOS 75%; healthy is under 20%)
Account balance	-₹6,320	You currently owe Amazon money

3.1 What this does to each sale

Your product sells at ₹333. Here is where that money actually goes, using your real packed weight and a National delivery:

₹333.00	selling price
– ₹118.00	Amazon fees including GST
– ₹6.10	storage
– ₹248.84	advertising
– ₹39.94	LOSS — before you have paid for the wire at all

Add the cost of the rope, the packaging and inbound freight, and the real loss per unit is larger still. This is why the balance is negative. **Every extra sale at this ad spend makes the position worse, not better.**

3.2 What to do today

1. **Pause the Sponsored Products campaign.** Seller Central → Advertising → Campaign Manager → pause. Not reduce — pause. Zero attributed sales over seven days means it is not working in its current form, and every day it runs costs about ₹265.
2. **Check what it was targeting.** Pull the **Search Term Report**. Zero attributed sales with real spend almost always means broad or automatic targeting matching irrelevant searches — people searching “electrical wire” or “rope” who never wanted a clothesline.
3. **Work out whether you are profitable without ads.** Your July sales continued while ads ran, but with ₹0 attributed to them — which strongly suggests most or all of those 32 units were **organic**. If so, pausing ads costs you almost nothing and immediately saves ₹7,960 a month.
4. **Restart small and controlled, later.** When you do restart: one campaign, exact-match keywords taken from terms that have already converted, and a daily budget of ₹50–100 — not ₹265. Your ceiling is set by margin: after fees you keep roughly ₹215 on a ₹333 sale, so your ACOS target must stay well under 60%, and realistically under 25% to build anything.

The encouraging part

Your operational account is genuinely healthy: Account Health Rating **200 (Healthy)**, Order Defect Rate **0%** across 42 orders, zero policy violations, zero cancellation and late-dispatch problems, and a Service Quality Score of **100/100**. You have not broken anything. The problem is one campaign, and it is switch-off-able today.

4 · How Selling on Amazon Actually Works

Amazon is two businesses at once: a shop where buyers find you, and a courier company that can store and deliver for you. It never buys your stock. Even under FBA, the goods in Amazon's warehouse still belong to you.

3.1 Where the money goes

1. The customer pays **Amazon** at checkout. Not you.
2. The order gets packed and shipped — by Amazon if you use FBA, by you if you self-ship.
3. Amazon subtracts its fees, adds **18% GST on those fees**, and records the **0.5% TCS** it withheld.
4. What is left goes to your bank account.
5. A **Settlement Report** lists every single deduction.

Read the Settlement Report, not your bank balance

The money that lands in your bank is a net figure with a dozen deductions baked in. The bank credit tells you *how much*. Only the Settlement Report tells you *why*. If a fee is charged wrongly, the bank statement will never show you that. Download it monthly.

3.2 When you get paid

VERIFIED Money becomes available **7 days after Amazon confirms delivery**. Amazon calls this **DD+7** (delivery date plus seven). This includes Pay-on-Delivery orders. For parcels without tracking, the clock starts from the estimated delivery date instead.

Source: Amazon Seller Forums, DD+7 announcement — sellercentral.amazon.com/seller-forums

What this means in practice: **your cash is always about 10–14 days behind your sales**. An order placed today, delivered in 4 days, pays out on day 11. Plan reorders around that gap, not around the date the order appeared.

CHECK LIVE Amazon's STEP programme can unlock faster payouts as your account matures. Your own settlement window is shown at the top of every settlement report.

3.3 Four ways to get an order to the customer

Method	Who stores, packs and ships	Prime badge?	Buy Box chances
FBA (what you use)	Amazon does all three	Yes, automatically	Best
Easy Ship	You store and pack. Amazon collects and delivers.	Invitation only	Lower
Seller Flex	Stock stays in your warehouse, but Amazon runs the process inside it	Case by case	Lower
Self-Ship	You do everything, with your own courier	No (except Local Shops, nearby pincodes)	Lowest

UNCONFIRMED Based on Amazon's published fulfilment channel comparison. The structure is widely documented; exact Prime and Buy Box wording was not independently re-verified.

3.4 The one formula behind every decision

Every sourcing and pricing choice in this book reduces to this. Chapter 8 explains each line.

Net profit = Selling price

- Product cost – Packaging – Inbound freight
- Referral fee – Closing fee
- Weight handling fee
- Pick & pack fee (FBA only)
- Storage fee (FBA only)
- GST at 18% on all Amazon fees
- Advertising – Expected return costs

Note what is not in this formula: TCS. The 0.5% Amazon withholds is not a cost — you claim it back as tax credit. It delays your cash; it does not reduce your profit. Do not subtract it here or you will understate every margin.

5 · Where You Are Now, And Your Next 30 Days

4.1 Already done

- GST registration complete.
- Seller Central account live under the seller name **BSNY Enterprises**.
- First product listed and selling: rope wire for cloth drying, ₹333, fulfilled by FBA.

4.1a Your listing, as it stands today VERIFIED

Read directly from your live product page on 4 August 2026.

Field	Value	What it means
ASIN	B0H4WZ8FBR	Your listing's permanent ID
Title	Rope Wire for Cloth Drying & Hanging Clothes — Clothesline, Heavy Gauge, Rust Proof, 12 Gauge, No Sagging, Length 22 Metres (Black)	Good keyword coverage already
Browse category	Home & Kitchen → Home Storage & Organisation → Laundry Organization → Clotheslines	Good news. Nowhere near the electrical “Wires” category. Your fee category is very likely a Home one.
Price / MRP	₹333 , MRP ₹500 — shown as 33% off, ₹15.14 per metre	MRP is declared and marked inclusive of taxes ✓
Brand	Generic	Confirmed. Brand Registry is unavailable and any seller can list against this ASIN — see 4.2.
Seller	BSNY Enterprises	—
Fulfilment	Fulfilled by Amazon ✓	FBA confirmed, so Chapter 8's FBA rates are the right ones
Reviews	5.0 stars, from 1 rating	Your single biggest growth constraint. See below.
Delivery reach	Quoted delivery to Mumbai 400001	You ship nationally — which changes your fee maths, see 9.2

One rating is the real bottleneck, not fees

You have **one review**. No amount of fee optimisation moves a listing that shoppers do not trust yet. At this stage getting to roughly 10–15 genuine reviews will do more for sales than anything else in this book.

Two levers available to you right now, both cheap: the automated **Request a Review** button on every delivered order, and an **insert card** in the packaging (22.1). Amazon Vine would be the third, but it needs Brand Registry — which needs a brand that is not “Generic”.

A pricing observation

You are showing ₹333 against an MRP of ₹500 — a permanent 33% discount. That is fine, but note the MRP you print on the package is a legal declaration (Chapter 7). Make sure the ₹500 on the listing matches the ₹500 printed on the physical label, because a mismatch between the two is a Legal Metrology problem, not just a marketing one.

4.2 Seller name vs brand name — these are different things

These two get confused constantly, so let us be precise. You have two separate name fields and they do different jobs.

Field	What it controls	Where it lives
Seller name (BSNY Enterprises)	Your business identity. This is the “Sold by” line on the product page.	Seller Central → account settings
Brand name (confirmed: Generic)	Sits on the <i>listing</i> . Trademarks, Brand Registry and A+ Content all attach to this field, not your seller name.	Your listing → Brand field

VERIFIED Your Brand field reads **Generic** — confirmed on the live product page on 4 August 2026. Everything below applies to you.

If your brand really is “Generic”, this is your weakest spot

A Generic listing is the most exposed position on Amazon. Any other seller can list against the same ASIN and compete on price. You get no brand protection. And Brand Registry — which unlocks A+ Content, Brand Store and Sponsored Brands — is **not available** while the Brand field says Generic.

How to fix it, in order

1. Pick a real brand name.
2. **Print it on the product or its packaging.** The brand must physically appear on the item — putting it only in the listing is not enough.
3. File a trademark application (Form TM-A) at the IP India portal.
4. Update the Brand field on your listing to match.
5. Apply for Brand Registry.

UNCONFIRMED Brand Registry is widely reported to accept a *pending* TM-A application number, so you need not wait for full registration. This was not verified against Amazon's own Brand Registry documentation. Confirm in the enrolment flow before budgeting time around it.

4.3 Your next 30 days

- ☐ **Check where your stock actually is.** Seller Central → Reports → Inventory Ledger. Set Summary view + Fulfilment centre + Last 30 days. Look for any FC code that is not in Telangana. This is a monthly job, not a one-time one — Amazon moves stock without telling you. (See 5.4.)
- ☐ **Check the TCS rate in your own records.** Make sure your margin sheet uses **0.5%**, not the widely-quoted 1% — see 5.3.
- ☐ **Open your listing's Fee Preview** and write down the exact *fee category* name. This is not the same as the browse category and it decides your fees. (See 8.2.)
- ☐ **Photograph your packaging** and check it against the labelling list in Chapter 7.

- ☐ **Confirm bank account and PAN are correctly linked** so payouts are not held.
- ☐ **Turn on the automated “Request a Review” button** for every order.
- ☐ **Check Account Health weekly** — Order Defect Rate, Late Shipment Rate, Cancellation Rate.
- ☐ **Set a monthly reminder** to download the settlement report and reconcile it against your GST returns.
- ☐ **File TM-A** if you have decided on a brand name. It is cheap and unlocks everything downstream.

6 • GST, TCS and Multi-State Stock

Fee mistakes cost rupees. Compliance mistakes cost listings. This chapter is the one with the corrected TCS rate — the single most important fix in this rebuild.

5.1 Why you must be GST-registered

Selling through a marketplace falls under **Section 24 of the CGST Act**. GST registration is compulsory for most e-commerce sellers regardless of turnover. You already have this, so you are fine.

UNCONFIRMED Since October 2023, unregistered persons and Composition Scheme taxpayers can sell through platforms like Amazon without full GST registration — **but only within their own state**. The moment an order crosses a state line, the exemption stops.

For an FBA seller this exemption is basically useless. The whole point of FBA is nationwide delivery, which the exemption cannot support. Mentioned only so you recognise it if an advisor brings it up.

5.2 Stock in another state means a new GST number there

UNCONFIRMED When Amazon stores your goods in a fulfilment centre **outside your home state**, GST law treats you as doing business in that state. Section 22 read with Section 25 of the CGST Act then requires a **separate GST registration for that state**. Section 2(85) is the reason: storing goods somewhere makes it a “place of business” even if you have no office or staff there.

Your GSTIN begins with **36**, the state code for Telangana. **VERIFIED** Your Inventory Ledger shows stock in **HYD3** (139 units) and **HYD8** (2 units) — both Hyderabad, Telangana. No out-of-state centre, so no second GSTIN is needed. **But both codes need to appear on your GST certificate** as additional places of business (6.5).

CHECK LIVE — that was true on the day someone looked. It is not a permanent state of affairs.

Never guess a state from an FC code

FC codes do not reliably indicate the state. DEL-prefixed centres (DEL2, DEL4, DEL5) are physically in **Haryana**, not Delhi. Some Bangalore-sounding codes are actually in **Tamil Nadu**. Always open the **full address** shown against that FC code in Seller Central before you register anywhere. Getting this wrong means registering in the wrong state entirely — far worse than registering late. Appendix F has a code list, with caveats.

Virtual Place of Business (VPOB)

A VPOB is a paid virtual address service that lets you get a GST number in a new state without renting an office.

UNCONFIRMED Market rates run roughly ₹500–₹3,000+ per month depending on provider, city and service tier.

A claim worth checking before you spend

VPOB services are often described as “explicitly recognised as legally valid” under CBIC Circulars 89/08/2019-GST and 161/17/2021. **That could not be confirmed**. Neither circular appears to address virtual places of business — 161/17/2021 concerns export of services and intermediaries. The phrasing appears mostly on VPOB providers' own sales pages.

VPOB is common and may be perfectly acceptable. But treat it as **a question for your CA**, not as settled law, and make sure the documents (NOC, rent or service agreement, utility bill) all match the address Amazon has on record.

5.3 TCS — the corrected number

TCS is 0.5%, not 1%

VERIFIED

Amazon withholds **0.5%** of your net taxable sales, split as **0.25% CGST + 0.25% SGST** for sales inside your state, or **0.5% IGST** for sales to other states. The rate was cut from 1% to 0.5% with effect from **10 July 2024** by CGST Notification 15/2024.

Sources: cleartax.in — [TCS under GST](#) · [BDO India](#) — [sellers on Amazon/Flipkart benefit from lower TCS](#)

TCS is not a cost. It appears in your GSTR-2A/2B as credit you can claim. It delays your cash; it does not reduce your profit. Never subtract it in a margin calculation.

The monthly TCS check — why it matters

Amazon files a return called **GSTR-8** every month, declaring how much TCS it collected against your GST number. If even one character of your GSTIN is wrong in Amazon's records, that money is credited to a number that is not yours. You still paid it. You just cannot claim it. Fixing that takes months.

Step	What to do
1. Check the GST portal	gst.gov.in → Login → Services → Returns → TCS Credit Received → pick the month → note the amount
2. Check Amazon's side	Seller Central → Reports → Payments → Transaction View → filter the month → add up every "Tax Collected at Source (TCS)" line
3. Compare	They should roughly match, and should be about 0.5% of that month's net taxable sales. If step 1 shows zero, your GSTIN is probably wrong in Amazon's records.
4. If they do not match	Seller Central → Settings → Account Info → Tax Information → check every character of your GSTIN → then raise a Seller Support case saying GSTR-8 TCS is not reflecting on the GST portal

A worked example. On ₹1,00,000 of net taxable sales in a month, TCS is **₹500** (0.5%). Working from the outdated 1% figure you would look for ₹1,000, find ₹500, and conclude something was broken. Nothing would be.

5.4 Your monthly compliance rhythm

When	What to do	Time needed
1st	Inventory Ledger → check which FCs hold your stock	2 minutes
11th	GST portal → TCS Credit Received for last month	5 minutes
11th	Check GSTR-1 auto-populated correctly	5 minutes
20th	File GSTR-3B	15 minutes with a CA

UNCONFIRMED

These are the standard monthly-filer dates, but confirm with your CA — GST due dates do shift, and quarterly schemes have different dates.

Set phone reminders. Missing this for two or three months in a row is how problems quietly pile up.

5.5 Your fulfilment centre must be on your GST certificate **ACTION NEEDED**

This is the most urgent item in this book. It is a compliance gap, not a fee question, and it is straightforward to fix.

What the rule is

VERIFIED Because storing goods somewhere makes it a “place of business” (Section 2(85), and 5.2 above), the Amazon fulfilment centre holding your stock must be declared on your GST registration as an **Additional Place of Business (APOB)**.

This is not merely a tax-adviser opinion — Amazon states it directly. Whenever Amazon opens a new fulfilment centre it tells sellers they must update their GST registration to include that centre as an additional place of business *before* sending inventory there. Amazon's FBA registration flow asks for the amended certificate (Form REG-14) for exactly this reason.

Sources: Amazon Seller Forums announcements for new fulfilment centres ([West Bengal](#), [Madhya Pradesh](#)) · [ClearTax — adding an additional place of business](#)

What your certificate currently shows

Your GST registration certificate (REG-06, issued 29 May 2026) states in Annexure A:

“Total Number of Additional Places of Business in the State: 0”

Meanwhile your stock is sitting in an Amazon fulfilment centre in Telangana and selling. **If you have not amended the registration since it was issued, the fulfilment centre is not declared** — and that is a gap worth closing this week.

The good news

Because the fulfilment centre is in **Telangana**, the same state as your registration, you do **not** need a new GSTIN and you do not need a VPOB service. You only need an **amendment** to the registration you already hold. It is a core-field amendment, filed free on the GST portal.

How to fix it

1. **Check first.** Log in to [gst.gov.in](#) → Services → User Services → **View/Download Certificates**. Download the current REG-06 and look at Annexure A. If a fulfilment centre address is already listed, you are compliant and can ignore the rest.
2. **Get the exact FC address.** Seller Central → Reports → Inventory Ledger tells you which centre holds your stock (HYD3, HYD8 or another). You need the **full postal address** Amazon records for it, not the code. Amazon publishes these for GST purposes; Seller Support will give you the address on request.
3. **File the amendment.** [gst.gov.in](#) → Services → Registration → **Amendment of Registration (Core Fields)** → Additional Place of Business → add the FC address → reason: “storage of goods at e-commerce fulfilment centre” → submit with DSC/EVC. This generates Form **REG-14**.
4. **Keep the updated certificate.** Amazon may ask for it, and you will want it if a notice ever arrives.

Ask your CA to confirm, then act

UNCONFIRMED One nuance worth a professional opinion: some advisers treat adding the FC as APOB as strictly mandatory, others as strongly advisable where the marketplace holds goods on your behalf. Either way the amendment is free, takes one sitting, and removes the exposure — so there is no practical argument for leaving it undone.

While your CA is on the phone: your GST liability began **27 May 2026**, so returns for June and July 2026 are now due or overdue. Confirm GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B have been filed for both months (5.4).

7 • Income Tax

GST and income tax are two separate obligations, and paying one does not settle the other. Many seller guides cover GST in detail and skip income tax entirely. This chapter gives you only what I could verify, and clearly flags the rest.

Scope warning, stated honestly

I verified the presumptive-taxation rates below against the Income Tax Department's own site. I did **not** verify advance-tax due dates, audit thresholds, ITR form numbers, or how the new Income Tax Act, 2025 changes the mechanics. Rather than guess, this chapter stops where my verification stopped. **Take the rest to a CA.** One consultation is cheap next to a penalty.

6.1 Two different taxes

	GST	Income tax
Taxed on	The sale (turnover)	Your profit
Paid	Monthly	Yearly, usually with instalments during the year
Covered in	Chapter 5	This chapter

6.2 Presumptive taxation (Section 44AD) — the simple route

Most small sellers use this. Instead of proving every expense, you declare a fixed percentage of turnover as profit and pay tax on that.

VERIFIED Under Section 44AD, deemed profit is:

- **8% of turnover** normally, or
- **6% of turnover** for money received through banking or electronic modes.

Source: Income Tax Department — [incometaxindia.gov.in](https://www.incometaxindia.gov.in), [benefits allowable to small businessmen](#)

VERIFIED The turnover limit is **₹2 crore**, extended to **₹3 crore** where cash receipts are 5% or less of total receipts.

Source: [clearfax.in](https://www.clearfax.in) — [Section 44AD presumptive scheme](#)

Why this suits an Amazon seller well

Amazon pays you by bank transfer. Effectively all your receipts are electronic. So you are likely eligible for the lower **6%** rate and the higher **₹3 crore** ceiling. On ₹20,00,000 of turnover, deemed profit would be ₹1,20,000 — and tax is calculated on that, not on your actual margin.

The catch worth knowing: if your real profit is *lower* than 6%, presumptive taxation makes you pay tax on profit you did not earn. Thin-margin sellers should compare both routes with a CA before choosing.

CHECK LIVE The **Income Tax Act, 2025** is now in force and has changed some presumptive-taxation mechanics around losses, deductions and rebates. The 6%/8% rates and the ₹2/₹3 crore limits are as verified above, but ask your CA how the new Act affects your specific filing.

6.3 What to ask your CA (bring this list)

- Should I use presumptive taxation (44AD) or normal books, given my actual margin?

- Do I owe advance tax, and on what dates?
- Which ITR form applies to me, and what is my filing deadline?
- What records must I keep, and for how long?
- How does the Income Tax Act, 2025 change anything for me this year?
- Is my GST input credit being claimed properly, including the TCS at 0.5%?

8 · Labelling Rules (Legal Metrology)

This applies to **every** pre-packed product sold in India, online or offline. There is no small-seller exemption. It is also the most common reason listings get suppressed.

UNCONFIRMED

Governed by the **Legal Metrology Act, 2009** and the **Packaged Commodities Rules, 2011**.

7.1 What must appear — on the package AND the listing page

Declaration	Notes
Name and address of the manufacturer, packer or importer	A full address, not just a city
Common or generic name of the product	What the thing actually is
Net quantity	In standard units. For your rope, that means length .
MRP, inclusive of all taxes	Must say it includes taxes
Month and year of manufacture or packing	
Consumer care contact	Phone number and/or email that works
Country of origin	Mandatory for imported goods
Dimensions where relevant	Applies to cable, rope and textile products — including yours

7.2 Who is responsible

- **If you repack, bundle, or private-label:** the obligation is yours.
- **If you resell a manufacturer's sealed product as-is:** check the declarations are present and not covered up. Do not add your own contradicting label.

The barcode mistake that gets shipments rejected

Your FNSKU barcode label must **not cover any required declaration** — not the MRP, not the net quantity, not the manufacturer address. Plan where the label goes *while designing the packaging*, not after Amazon refuses an inbound shipment.

7.3 What happens if you get it wrong

Fines, seizure of goods, listing takedown, action against your whole account, and in serious or repeated cases, prosecution. Amazon's automated systems also suppress listings with incomplete compliance fields, often before you notice sales have stopped.

7.4 Business structure — context, not urgent

A sole proprietorship with GST — what you have — is entirely enough to sell on Amazon. An LLP or Private Limited becomes worth considering when you pursue Brand Registry under a registered trademark, take on investors, or reach a size where personal liability protection matters.

8 • The Complete Fee Structure

Amazon charges four main fees, plus GST on all of them. This chapter explains each one in plain terms, tells you exactly how confident you can be in each number, and flags the one thing you must confirm inside your own account.

Official page: sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing · Last checked for this rebuild: **4 August 2026** · Next review due: February 2027, or immediately if you see a fee announcement in Seller Central → Announcements.

8.1 The four fees, in one table

Fee	What you are paying for	Charged when
Referral fee	Amazon's commission — a percentage of the sale price	Every sale
Closing fee	A flat fee per sale, set by price band and category group	Every sale
Weight handling fee	Delivering the parcel to the customer	Every sale (FBA and Easy Ship)
Pick & pack fee	Amazon's staff picking and packing the unit	Every sale (FBA only)
Storage fee	Holding your stock in the warehouse	Monthly, while stock sits
Removal / disposal fee	Sending unsold stock back, or scrapping it	Only if you ask
GST at 18%	Tax on all the fees above	Always

8.2 Referral fee — Amazon's commission

Referral fee = Selling price × Referral fee %

VERIFIED Since **16 March 2026**, the referral fee is **0% on products priced up to ₹1,000 across more than 1,800 categories**. This was an expansion of an earlier scheme that only covered products under ₹300. Amazon also cut referral fees by 4%–9.5% for several high-demand categories priced above ₹1,000.

Sources: [Amazon India's own announcement](#) · [Seller Forums fee update notice](#)

It is “most categories”, not “all”

It is tempting to shorten this to “referral fee is 0% under ₹1,000”. That is not accurate. 1,800+ categories is most of them, not all of them, and Appendix A contradicts the shortcut on dozens of rows. **Never assume 0% — check your category.**

Real exceptions — categories that charge below ₹1,000

VERIFIED from the live fee page on 4 August 2026:

Category	Fee below ₹1,000
Mattresses	25.5% up to ₹500, then 0% from ₹500–₹1,000
Office Furniture — study tables, office & gaming chairs	16.5% up to ₹500, then 0% from ₹500–₹1,000
Wires (electrical, house wiring, ad-hoc use)	0% only up to ₹300 , then 10%
Tiles & Flooring Accessories	0% only up to ₹300 , then 8%

VERIFIED More categories that charge something below ₹1,000: Books (2%–4%), Laptops (6% at all prices), Desktops (8%), Mobile phones (5%), Televisions (6%), Kindle Accessories (25%), Camera Lenses (7%), GPS Devices (13.5%), Memory Cards (16%), Hard Disks (9.5%), Monitors (6.5%), Speakers (11%), OTC Medicine (12%),

Prescription Medicines (8%), Warranty Services (10%), Modems (14%), Pen Drives (16%), and several Musical Instruments lines.

Good news about Appendix A

I read Amazon's live fee page and got real text back for the whole Home, Décor, Home Improvement, Furniture, Outdoor and Lawn & Garden section — and then the rest of it. **All 219 categories and 503 individual price rules were extracted directly from the live page.** Appendix A is verified in full.

The trap: fee category is not browse category

The category a shopper sees is **not** necessarily the category Amazon bills you under. Your rope product could sit under “Home — Other Products”, “Home Improvement — Other Products”, or even “Wires (Electrical...)” depending on how Amazon's catalogue team classified it. Those carry very different rates above ₹1,000: 18%, 13.5% and 10%.

CHECK LIVE Find your real fee category at Seller Central → Manage Inventory → your SKU → Fee Preview. Do this once and write it down.

Your category, at a glance

Category	Up to ₹1,000	Above ₹1,000
Home — Other Products	0%	18%
Home Improvement — Other Products	0%	13.5%
Home Storage (excluding kitchen containers)	0% V	15% V
Home Decor Products	0% V	17% V
Home Improvement — Accessories	0% V	13.5% V
Wires (electrical, house wiring)	0% only to ₹300 V	10% above ₹300 V
Kitchen — Other Products	0%	12.5%
Your rope wire at ₹333	0% under every classification above except “Wires”, which would charge 10% = ₹33.30 . This is exactly why you must check your fee category.	

V = verified on the live page, 4 August 2026.

8.3 Closing fee — now fully verified

A flat rupee amount charged on every sale. It depends on your **price band**, your **fee category group**, and your **fulfilment channel**. This is the fee that genuinely changes between FBA, Easy Ship and Self-Ship.

Verified from Amazon's own rate card

VERIFIED Amazon's actual closing-fee rate-card images settle a point that is widely reported incorrectly: **there IS a closing fee above ₹500**. On FBA it is **₹27** for ₹501–1,000 and **₹52** above ₹1,000 (₹72 for select fee categories).

The complete closing fee table, all channels

Item price (incl. shipping)	FBA / FC	Easy Ship	Self-Ship	Seller Flex
₹0–300	₹26 (Group #) · ₹20 (A) · ₹13 (B)	₹1	₹20	₹6
₹301–500	₹22 (Group ##) · ₹18 (C) · ₹14 (D)	₹22	₹26	₹12
₹501–1,000	₹27 (all categories)	₹45	₹51	₹35
Above ₹1,000	₹52 · ₹72 for select categories	₹76	₹101	₹66

Source: read directly from Amazon's own rate-card images on the live fee page, 4 August 2026 — sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing. Image files: *FC_Closing_fee2026.jpg*, *FC_Weight_H_fee.jpg*, *FC_hB_v2Fees2026.jpg*, plus the Easy Ship, Self-Ship and Seller Flex equivalents.

How to read the FBA column. Below ₹500, Amazon splits categories into groups. “Standard Fee” categories pay the highest rate (₹26 / ₹22). Selected categories get cheaper rates: Group A/C, or the cheapest Group B/D. Appendix B lists which category sits in which group. **From ₹501 upward the groups stop mattering** — every category pays the same.

The ₹72 asterisk, explained

Amazon's own footnote reads: for items priced above ₹1,000, a ₹72 closing fee applies to *select fee categories*. So **₹52 is the normal rate above ₹1,000** and ₹72 is the exception. Guides that mention only the ₹72 figure and imply everything else is free are wrong on the second half.

Why this matters more than it looks

Self-Ship costs **₹101** above ₹1,000 while FBA costs **₹52**. On a ₹1,200 product that is a ₹49 swing per unit before GST — the opposite of what most sellers assume about FBA being the expensive option. Closing fee alone can justify FBA at higher price points.

8.4 Weight handling fee — the delivery charge

- **Self-Ship:** Amazon charges nothing. You pay your courier directly.
- **FBA and Easy Ship:** Amazon charges based on weight and distance.

The two channels bundle costs differently, which trips people up. Easy Ship's single weight-handling number covers both collection from you and delivery to the customer, because you already did the storing and packing. FBA splits it into three separate lines: weight handling for delivery, pick & pack for the labour, and storage for holding stock. Three FBA lines where Easy Ship shows one — so FBA looks more expensive at a glance even when it is not.

Chargeable weight = whichever is HIGHER of:

- (a) actual weight
- (b) volumetric weight

Volumetric weight in kg = (Length × Breadth × Height in cm) ÷ 5000

Why volumetric weight exists: a big light box takes up as much van space as a small heavy one. A 40×30×20 cm box has a volumetric weight of 4.8 kg. If the contents weigh 1 kg, you are still billed for 4.8 kg. Smaller boxes save real money.

Is your item Standard or Heavy & Bulky?

UNCONFIRMED It is Heavy & Bulky if **any one** of these is true:

- It belongs to a large-appliance category — washing machines, fridges, ACs, microwaves, chimneys, dishwashers, TVs, treadmills, cycles with wheels over 20 inches, large furniture, deep freezers
- Package weight is over **22.5 kg**
- Longest side is over **72 inches / 183 cm**
- Girth is over **118 inches / 300 cm**, where girth = Length + 2 × (Width + Height)
- It ships in multiple boxes, or needs carpenter installation

Distance zones

Cheapest to most expensive: **Local** (same city) → **Regional** (same region, different city) → **National** (different region).

Region	States and union territories
Region 1	Chandigarh, Delhi, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, J&K, Punjab, Rajasthan, Uttarakhand, UP Zone A
Region 2	Dadra & Nagar Haveli, Daman & Diu, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra
Region 3	Andaman & Nicobar, Andhra Pradesh, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, Puducherry, Tamil Nadu, Telangana , Lakshadweep
Region 4	Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Odisha, Sikkim, Tripura, UP Zone B, West Bengal

You are in Telangana, so Region 3. Orders within Region 3 are Regional. Within Telangana may count as Local. Anything to Regions 1, 2 or 4 is National and costs most.

The actual rate card

VERIFIED Amazon publishes this table as an **image**, which is why most guides omit it or simply tell you to use the calculator. Here it is. Note the key fact almost nobody mentions: **your weight handling fee depends on your STEP level (8.9).**

FBA standard-size weight handling fee, per shipment

Based on outbound shipping weight. Effective 16 March 2026.

STEP level	Weight band	Regional	National
Premium & Advanced	First 500 g	₹37	₹63
	500 g – 1 kg	₹52	₹83
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹76	₹120
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹24	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹13	₹18
Standard assume this unless you know otherwise	First 500 g	₹39	₹65
	500 g – 1 kg	₹54	₹85
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹78	₹122
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹24	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹13	₹18

STEP level	Weight band	Regional	National
Basic	First 500 g	₹42	₹69
	500 g – 1 kg	₹58	₹89
	1 kg – 2 kg	₹82	₹126
	Each extra kg after 2 kg	₹24	₹34
	Each extra kg after 5 kg	₹13	₹18

Source: read directly from Amazon's own rate-card images on the live fee page, 4 August 2026 — sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing. Image files: *FC_Closing_fee2026.jpg*, *FC_Weight_H_fee.jpg*, *FC_hB_v2Fees2026.jpg*, plus the Easy Ship, Self-Ship and Seller Flex equivalents.

Two things to notice

1. There is no Local column for standard FBA. Only Regional and National — even though Local is widely listed elsewhere. For standard-size FBA items there is no Local rate. Local pricing does exist for Heavy & Bulky (table below).

2. A better STEP level makes every parcel cheaper. Moving from Basic to Standard saves ₹3–4 per shipment; Premium saves ₹2 more. On 500 orders a month that is real money, and it is the cheapest cost reduction available to you because it needs no renegotiation with anyone.

FBA Heavy & Bulky weight handling fee, per shipment

STEP level	Weight band	Local	Regional	National
Premium & Advanced	First 12 kg	₹108	₹158	₹298
Standard		₹110	₹160	₹300
Basic		₹114	₹164	₹304
All levels	Each extra kg, 12–25 kg	₹6	₹10	₹18
	Each extra kg above 25 kg	₹5	₹6	₹12

Note the jump. A Heavy & Bulky item shipped National starts at ₹300 versus ₹65 for a standard parcel. Crossing that size threshold multiplies your delivery cost roughly fivefold — which is why 8.4's size rules and Chapter 19's packaging advice matter so much.

Minimum weight and how it is counted

VERIFIED Amazon's page states: for standard-size items the minimum chargeable weight is **500 g**, and heavier items are charged in multiples of the 500 g rate. Its worked example: an 800 g package shipped Regional via Easy Ship costs **₹68 = ₹51 (first 500 g) + ₹17 (next 500 g)**.

VERIFIED Amazon also confirms: shipping fees are computed on **volumetric or actual weight, whichever is higher**, with volumetric weight = $(L \times B \times H) \div 5000$, dimensions in cm.

8.5 Pick & pack fee (FBA only)

VERIFIED Amazon's page states this fee is charged per unit sold:

- **Standard items:** ₹17 up to 1 kg, then +₹5 per extra kg up to 5 kg, then +₹2 per extra 5 kg
- **Heavy & Bulky:** ₹26 per unit sold

Verified against the fee-definitions text on sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing, 4 August 2026.

Easy to miss, applies to every single unit

This is billed separately from the delivery fee, so people forget it. It applies to **every FBA unit you sell**. Give it its own line in your margin sheet — do not fold it into shipping.

8.6 Storage fee (FBA only)

VERIFIED ₹50 per cubic foot per month — Amazon's own wording, confirmed on the live page. Rates rise during the October–December peak.

Verified against the fee-definitions text on sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing, 4 August 2026.

The aged-stock clock starts earlier than you may expect

VERIFIED The aged-inventory surcharge moved to **181 days** on **16 January 2026**, down from 271 — a full 90 days earlier. Guidance still quoting 271 or 365 days is out of date.

Sources: [Parker-Lambert on the 181-day change](#) · [Adbrew — aged inventory surcharge 2026](#). These sources describe Amazon's global rate card. **CHECK LIVE** Confirm the India figure on your own Inventory Age dashboard.

What to do about it: if you were planning a 9-month stock runway, cut it. Send a small test batch for any new product and restock based on how fast it actually sells. Watch the Inventory Age report and discount or remove stock before it crosses the threshold.

8.7 Removal and disposal fees

VERIFIED Charged **per unit**, if you ask Amazon to send unsold stock back to you:

Size	Standard shipping	Expedited shipping
Standard	₹10	₹30
Heavy & Bulky	₹100	₹100

Disposal fees apply if you ask Amazon to scrap stock instead of returning it. **CHECK LIVE** — the disposal rate is not on the public fee page, so check it in Seller Central at the time you request removal.

8.8 GST and TCS on fees

VERIFIED **18% GST applies to every fee in this chapter** — referral, closing, weight handling, pick & pack, storage, removal. It is added on top of the fee. It is not charged on your sale price.

VERIFIED **TCS is 0.5%**, withheld from your sales and claimable back as input tax credit. See 5.3. It affects cash flow, not profit.

A quick example of how GST on fees works

Say your fees on one sale are ₹18 closing + ₹40 weight handling + ₹17 pick & pack = ₹75. GST at 18% on ₹75 is **₹13.50**. So the true cost of those fees is **₹88.50**, not ₹75. Forgetting the GST understates your fees by nearly a fifth.

8.9 Your STEP level — the discount tier you are already in

Amazon automatically places every seller into a performance tier called STEP, and that tier changes what you pay. Two sellers shipping identical parcels pay different weight-handling fees because of it. Almost no guide covers this.

VERIFIED There are four levels — **Basic, Standard, Advanced, Premium**. You are **enrolled automatically**; there is nothing to sign up for. Every new seller starts at **Standard**.

Source: sell.amazon.in/grow-your-business/step, read 4 August 2026.

What each level gets you

Benefit	Basic	Standard (you)	Advanced	Premium
Weight handling fee waiver	None	₹4	₹6	₹6
Refund fee waiver	None	Up to ₹10	Up to ₹30	Up to ₹30
Long-term storage fee waiver	None	None	None	20% off
Payment reserve period	10 days	7 days	7 days	3 days
Disbursement cycle	Weekly	Weekly	Weekly	Daily
Account management	No	No	On criteria	Guaranteed
Service Provider Network credits	No	No	Worth ₹3,540	Worth ₹7,080
Seller Connect event invitations	No	No	Yes	Yes
Priority 24×7 support	No	No	No	Yes

Verified from Amazon's STEP programme benefits table, 4 August 2026.

Where you stand right now, and what it is worth

On **Standard** you already have the ₹4 weight-handling waiver and the 7-day payment reserve — which is exactly why Chapter 3.2 says you are paid 7 days after delivery. That figure is **your level's figure**, not a universal rule. A Basic seller waits 10 days.

The waiver is already baked into the rates in 8.4. That is why your National first-500 g rate is **₹65** while a Basic seller pays **₹69** — a ₹4 difference, exactly the waiver.

Your actual STEP position, from the dashboard **VERIFIED**

You are at **Standard**, based on performance from 1 April to 30 June 2026, and those benefits hold until **4 October 2026**. Next evaluation: **5 October 2026**. Your current benefits show as **₹4 off weight handling** and a **7-day payment reserve** — exactly as this table predicts.

Your performance metrics are outstanding. Cancellation rate 0%, late dispatch 0%, seller-controllable returns 0%, out-of-stock 0%, listing quality 100%, Prime views 100%, Service Quality Score 100/100. Every quality gate is already met.

What is actually blocking you from Advanced

Not quality — **scale**. Two eligibility gates and two growth metrics:

Requirement	You have	Target	Status
Minimum orders	54	30	Met ✓
Minimum active offers	1	5	Not met — this is your blocker
Local in-stock %	5.71%	20%	Not met
Net sales (either one)	₹9,231 / 27 units	₹5,00,000 / 2,000 units	Far off

The single most useful thing: you need **5 active listings** and you have 1. Amazon's own dashboard also nudges you to add listings and flags a **New Seller Incentive worth ₹41,000** that is worth reading before you spend more on ads. Adding 4 more products moves you toward Advanced *and* spreads your risk off a single SKU.

What moving up is actually worth to you

Move	What changes	Worth it?
Standard → Advanced	Weight handling waiver rises ₹4 → ₹6 (₹2 saved per shipment). Refund fee waiver rises ₹10 → ₹30. Plus ₹3,540 of Service Provider Network credits, account management and event invitations.	Yes. At 300 orders a month the ₹2 alone is ₹600, and the ₹3,540 credit is real money.

Move	What changes	Worth it?
Advanced → Premium	Payment reserve drops 7 → 3 days and disbursement becomes daily instead of weekly. 20% off long-term storage. ₹7,080 credits. Priority support.	Big cash-flow win. Daily payouts at 3 days versus weekly at 7 roughly halves the cash tied up in transit.

How you move up

VERIFIED STEP is judged on **seller-controllable metrics** — Amazon names cancellation rate, late dispatch rate and return rate among others. Evaluation is **quarterly**: your performance last quarter sets your level by the **5th day of the next quarter**.

The practical takeaway

Because you use FBA, Amazon handles dispatch — so **late dispatch and cancellation rates are largely out of your hands and should already be strong**. That makes **return rate** your main lever, which comes back to accurate listings, honest photos and correct sizing information (Chapter 20).

Check your STEP dashboard in Seller Central. It shows your current level, the metrics behind it, and Amazon's own customised recommendations for reaching the next one. Since evaluation is quarterly, acting early in a quarter matters more than acting late.

UNCONFIRMED Amazon also mentions an extra weight-handling fee waiver for enabling **Sunday Shipout**. If you can support Sunday dispatch, it is worth asking about.

9 • Your Product, Worked Out

Rope wire for cloth drying, ₹333, FBA, dispatched from Telangana, Standard STEP level. Every fee below is now verified. Only two things remain unknown, and both take minutes to settle.

9.0 Your verified measurements VERIFIED

Read from your listing's Offer and Product Details tabs on 4 August 2026.

Field	Value	Consequence
Package dimensions	4.4 × 13.3 × 13.4 cm	Volumetric weight = 784 cm ³ ÷ 5000 = 157 g
Package weight	0.46 kg (460 g)	Actual beats volumetric, so you are billed on 460 g
Chargeable weight	460 g	Inside the first 500 g band — the cheapest one. Good news: ₹39 Regional / ₹65 National.
Item weight (product only)	440 g	Packaging adds just 20 g — already efficient
SKU / FNSKU	BSNY-WIRE-22M / X002M6Y2YD	—
MRP field	₹499	Check the physical label shows the same figure (Chapter 8)
HSN code declared	72179099	Iron/steel wire. Confirm the GST rate you charge matches this code.
Stock on hand	139 at HYD3 + 2 at HYD8 = 141	≈4–5 months cover at 32 units/month. Storage ≈ ₹195/month (3.9 cu ft).
Sales rank	206,080 in Home & Kitchen	Low visibility — expected this early

One field still to confirm: your fee category

Your Offer tab shows **Product Type: WIRE**. Your browse path is Home & Kitchen → Laundry Organization → Clotheslines, which points to a Home fee category. But “WIRE” as the product type leaves open the possibility Amazon bills you under “Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)”.

It is worth ₹44 per unit. Open Fee Preview and read the referral and closing fee. If referral is ₹0 you are on a Home category. If it is about ₹33 you are on Wires and should raise a catalogue correction with Seller Support — your product is a PVC-coated clothesline, not house wiring.

9.1 Amazon's cut per unit, both scenarios VERIFIED

Fee category	Zone	Fees	+18% GST	Total	Share
Home (₹0 referral, ₹18 closing)	Regional	₹74.00	₹13.32	₹87.32	26.2%
	National	₹100.00	₹18.00	₹118.00	35.4%
Wires (₹33.30 referral, ₹22 closing)	Regional	₹111.30	₹20.03	₹131.33	39.4%
	National	₹137.30	₹24.71	₹162.01	48.7%

All rows use pick & pack ₹17 and your verified 460 g weight at Standard STEP level.

9.2 Fee detail

Line item	Amount	Basis
Selling price	₹333	—
Referral fee	₹0 or ₹33.30 if classed as “Wires”	VERIFIED 0% up to ₹1,000 for Home categories. “Wires” is 0% only to ₹300, then 10%.
Closing fee	₹18 or ₹22 if classed as “Wires”	VERIFIED Home categories are tier 1 → ₹18 in the ₹301–500 band. Wires is Standard tier → ₹22.
Weight handling	₹39 Regional ₹65 National	VERIFIED Standard STEP, first 500 g. Rises to ₹54 / ₹85 for 500 g–1 kg.
Pick & pack	₹17	VERIFIED Standard item up to 1 kg
Storage	₹50 per cubic foot / month	VERIFIED On stock held, not per sale
GST on fees	18% of the above	VERIFIED
TCS	₹1.67 withheld	VERIFIED 0.5% — refundable, not a cost

9.2 Amazon's total cut, four scenarios

Assuming a Home fee category (₹0 referral, ₹18 closing) and Standard STEP level. **Your listing quotes delivery to Mumbai**, which is Region 2 — so from Telangana a large share of your orders will be **National**, not Regional. Plan on the National rows.

Packed weight & destination	Fees	+18% GST	Amazon takes	Share of ₹333
Up to 500 g — Regional	₹74	₹13.32	₹87.32	26%
Up to 500 g — National	₹100	₹18.00	₹118.00	35%
500 g – 1 kg — Regional	₹89	₹16.02	₹105.02	32%
500 g – 1 kg — National	₹120	₹21.60	₹141.60	43%

Fees = closing (₹18) + weight handling + pick & pack (₹17). Storage excluded — it depends on how long stock sits, not on each sale.

The number that should change how you think

Amazon's cut ranges from **₹87 to ₹142** on the same product, decided by nothing but parcel weight and buyer location. That is **26% to 43% of your selling price** before you have paid for the rope.

Two consequences. **Weight is your biggest controllable cost** — keeping the packed coil under 500 g saves ₹15–₹21 per order versus 1 kg. And **distant orders earn far less**, which you cannot control. Price against the National figure, not the Regional one, or your average order will quietly underperform your spreadsheet.

9.3 Your two remaining actions

- 1. Weigh the packed coil.** Under 500 g saves ₹15 per Regional order and ₹20 per National order versus the next band. If it is marginally over, tighter packing is free margin.

2. **Open Fee Preview and read the fee category name.** If it says “Wires (Electrical...)” instead of a Home category, you pay **₹33.30 referral plus a ₹22 closing fee** rather than ₹0 and ₹18 — about **₹44 more per sale including GST**. On 100 orders a month that is ₹4,400.

A worked profit figure

Take the middle case: under 500 g, National delivery, Home category. Amazon takes **₹118**, leaving **₹215** to cover rope, packaging, inbound freight, advertising and returns — and to be your profit.

If rope plus packaging costs ₹120, your net is about **₹95 a unit, roughly 29% margin** — comfortably above the 20% floor in Chapter 11. At ₹180 it is ₹35, about 10%, and not worth scaling.

10 · Choosing a Fulfilment Channel

Feature	FBA	Easy Ship	Self-Ship
Storage cost	Amazon fee (8.6)	You bear it	You bear it
Pick & pack cost	Amazon fee (8.5)	You bear it	You bear it
Delivery cost	Amazon fee (8.4)	Amazon fee (8.4)	You pay your courier
Pay on Delivery	Yes	Yes	No
Prime badge	Yes	Invitation only	No (except Local Shops)
Buy Box chances	Best	Lower	Lowest
Best suited to	Fast-moving items with decent margin	Own warehouse, tight margins, wide range	Own warehouse plus reliable local delivery

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Based on Amazon's published channel comparison table; wording not independently re-verified.

You are on FBA, which is the right default for a single fast-moving SKU: you get the Prime badge, the best Buy Box odds, and you are not packing parcels yourself. The trade-off is three separate fee lines and storage charges that punish slow stock.

11 • Pricing and Margin Calculator

Build this once as a spreadsheet, one row per product. Reuse it every time you consider a new item and every time Amazon changes its fees.

Net profit = Selling price

- Product cost
- Packaging
- Inbound freight
- Referral fee
- Closing fee
- Weight handling fee
- Pick & pack fee
- Storage (if applicable)
- GST at 18% on all Amazon fees
- Advertising
- Expected return costs

Break-even price = Total cost ÷ (1 – referral fee %)
(only needed where a % referral fee actually applies)

Columns your spreadsheet needs

Column	Where the number comes from
Selling price	Your decision
Product cost	Supplier invoice
Packaging	Actual cost per unit, including the label
Inbound freight per unit	Total freight ÷ units in the shipment
Fee category	Fee Preview — write down the exact name
Referral %	Appendix A, matched to that fee category
Closing fee	Fee Preview (do not guess above ₹500)
Weight handling	Revenue Calculator, using packed weight
Pick & pack	₹17 standard up to 1 kg
GST on fees	= 18% × (all Amazon fees)
Ad cost per unit	Ad spend ÷ units sold
Return allowance	Your category's return rate × cost per return
Net profit and net margin %	Calculated

The rule that protects you

If a product cannot clear roughly **20% net margin** after every line above, pass on it — no matter how good the sales volume looks. Volume on a thin-margin product just means you lose money faster and tie up cash doing it.

Rebuild this sheet whenever fees change. Amazon has revised its India fee schedule at least twice in the last two years, including the big March 2026 change.

12 · Money Words Explained

The terms you will hit as soon as you start advertising or add a second product.

12.1 Advertising numbers

$ACOS = \text{Ad spend} \div \text{Ad sales} \times 100$ (lower is better)
 $ROAS = \text{Ad sales} \div \text{Ad spend}$ (higher is better)
 $TACOS = \text{Ad spend} \div \text{TOTAL sales} \times 100$ (ads + organic together)

- **ACOS and ROAS say the same thing from opposite ends.** 25% ACOS is the same as 4× ROAS. Do not let a tool quoting one confuse you.
- **TACOS is the more honest number.** It shows what share of *all* your revenue goes to ads, not just the sales ads get credit for. If TACOS falls over months while ACOS stays flat, your organic sales are growing. That is the healthiest signal there is.

12.2 Profit numbers

$\text{Break-even price} = \text{Total cost} \div (1 - \text{referral fee \%})$
 $\text{Contribution margin} = \text{Selling price} - \text{all variable costs}$
 $ROI = \text{Net profit} \div \text{total invested} \times 100$

- **Contribution margin** tells you what one extra sale adds after variable costs. It is the number that decides whether to keep a product alive.
- **ROI** matters when two products compete for the same money. A product with 30% margin that sells out monthly beats one with 50% margin that takes a year to move.

12.3 Cash and stock health

Term	What it means for you
Working capital	Cash locked in unsold stock plus money Amazon has not paid you yet. Amazon holds funds until 7 days after delivery, so plan reorders around that lag.
Inventory turnover	How many times you sell through your average stock. Low turnover is normal for the first 4–6 weeks of a new product. If it stays low, that is information, not bad luck.
Dead stock	Stock sitting long enough that storage fees eat the margin. With the surcharge now starting at 181 days, this bites sooner than it used to.
Cash conversion cycle	Time from paying your supplier to receiving Amazon's settlement. The longer it is, the more cash buffer you need.

Track these together, not one at a time

A product with a great margin and terrible turnover still drains your cash. A product with a thin margin that sells out every month can fund your growth. Neither number tells the story alone.

13 · Open vs Gated Categories

Most categories are open to any registered seller from day one. A smaller set need Amazon's approval first — this is called **gating**. It exists where there is a safety, authenticity or legal risk.

13.1 Usually open

- **Home & Kitchen and Home Improvement** — your current category
- Office Products
- Sports & Fitness (most sub-categories)
- Apparel & Footwear (most sub-categories)
- Toys & Games (most sub-categories; gating tightens around the festive quarter)
- Pet Supplies (most sub-categories)
- Automotive accessories and non-critical parts

13.2 Usually gated

Category	Why
Grocery & Gourmet Food	Safety, shelf life, FSSAI licensing
Jewellery & Watches	High value — counterfeit and fraud risk
Health supplements, OTC medicine, regulated healthcare (menstrual cups, contact lenses, diagnostic kits)	Health claims and regulatory approval
Automotive parts, batteries, hazmat-adjacent items	Safety and dangerous-goods handling
Selected toys and baby/children's sub-categories	Child safety certification
Products belonging to a brand in Brand Registry	You need a supplier invoice or brand authorisation

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Gating is decided per product and changes over time. **CHECK LIVE** always.

13.3 How to ask for approval

1. Seller Central → Catalogue → Add Products → search the ASIN or category
2. Click **Listing Limitations** → **Request Approval**

3. Upload supplier invoices (usually dated within about 90 days) plus any certificate required
4. Track it in your Seller Central case log. Approval takes days to a few weeks.

Build history first

Get 60–90 days of clean order history in an open category before you attempt a gated one. Approval odds improve with account age and a healthy record. Applying on day one with no history is the most common way to get refused.

14 • Banned and Restricted Products

This list is illustrative, not complete. Always check Amazon's own Restricted Products pages before you source anything you are unsure about.

- Illegal drugs, weapons, ammunition, explosives
- Counterfeit goods, or branded goods you are not authorised to sell
- Stolen goods
- Hazardous or recalled products without the required certification
- Anything infringing a patent, trademark or copyright
- Human body parts or organs; endangered wildlife products
- Obscene or offensive material

Check before you buy, not after

CHECK LIVE Seller Central → Help → search “Restricted Products”. Reversing a sourcing decision costs you a supplier conversation. Reversing a suspended listing costs you weeks and possibly your account.

15 • Product Research

A repeatable check to run before you spend money on any new product.

What to check	What good looks like
Demand	A steady Best Sellers Rank over time, not one spike. One spike usually means a sale event or a fad.
Competition	The top 3–5 listings ideally under roughly 500–1,000 reviews. Thousands of reviews means you cannot catch up on trust alone.
Margin	At least about 20% net after <i>every</i> fee in Chapter 8, at a price people actually pay.
Weight and size	Lighter and more compact means cheaper delivery, cheaper pick & pack, cheaper storage, and less damage in transit.
Compliance	Confirm gating (13) and labelling feasibility (7) <i>before</i> you place the order.

15.1 Free research you can do today

- **Amazon Best Sellers and Movers & Shakers** pages, by category
- **“Customers also bought”** on products next to yours — shows real buying patterns
- **1-star to 3-star reviews on category leaders.** This is the single richest free source there is. People tell you exactly what is wrong with the current products. Fix that and you have a reason to exist.

15.2 Paid tools

Helium 10, Jungle Scout and AMZScout are built primarily for the US market. Their India data is weaker, but the trends are still useful. Worth paying for only once you are sourcing at volume — not for your first or second product.

16 · Can You Legally Sell It?

Run every new product through this before ordering. The important question is not “can I make money on this” — it is “**am I allowed to sell this at all**”.

Question	Applies to	Where to check
Is the category gated?	Grocery, jewellery, supplements, automotive parts, some toys and baby items	Chapter 13
Does it need BIS certification?	Electricals, switches, wires and cables, pressure cookers, toys with electronics, helmets, LED products	bis.gov.in
Does it need an FSSAI licence?	Any food, drink or consumable, including supplements	foscoss.fssai.gov.in
Does it need CDSCO approval?	Medical devices — glucometers, BP monitors, thermometers	cdsco.gov.in
Is it hazmat / dangerous goods?	Batteries, aerosols, flammable liquids, magnets, chemicals, pressurised containers	Seller Central → Help → Hazmat
Does it need a barcode (GTIN)?	Any product new to Amazon	Chapter 19
Does your brand name clash with a trademark?	Own-brand products	ipindiaonline.gov.in
Can you meet labelling rules?	Every pre-packed product	Chapter 7
Do you have manufacturer details on file?	Every product	Supplier invoice
Is shelf life or expiry relevant?	Food, cosmetics, supplements, batteries	Supplier spec sheet

16.1 Worked example — your rope wire

Check	Answer
Gated?	No. Home & Kitchen is open.
BIS?	Probably not. BIS covers electrical wire for house wiring, not a non-electrical clothesline. But get your supplier to confirm in writing that it is not sold or described as an electrical product. <i>Note: this also affects your fee category — see 8.2.</i>
FSSAI / CDSCO?	No. Not food, not a medical device.
Hazmat?	No.
Barcode?	Check whether the supplier's packaging already has a GS1 barcode. If not, apply for GTIN exemption (19.1).
Labelling?	Yes. Net length, manufacturer address, MRP, month/year of packing, consumer care contact.
EPR plastic?	Possibly. You use poly bag or shrink wrap. Status for micro/small brand owners is unresolved — see 17.5.

16.2 Worked example — an LED bulb (a tempting next product)

Check	Answer
Gated?	LED bulbs sit in an open fee category (14% above ₹1,000, 0% below — verified). But that is a <i>fee</i> question, not a legal one.
BIS?	Yes. LED lighting falls under mandatory BIS registration. You cannot legally sell without it.
Hazmat?	No, unless a variant contains a lithium battery.
Labelling?	Yes — wattage, lumens, manufacturer details, MRP.

Why this example is in the book

An LED bulb looks like an easy win: open category, 0% referral fee under ₹1,000. And it is **illegal to sell without BIS registration**. The fee table and the legal check are two completely separate questions. A product can pass one and fail the other. Always run both.

16.3 Does this product already belong to someone else?

A different question from everything above. Not “can this category be sold” but “does this specific item already have an owner”. Skipping this is how sellers become accidental counterfeiters and get an IP complaint in week one.

Step	How	Where
Search the exact product on Amazon	If a near-identical listing shows a “Visit the [X] Store” link, it is brand-protected. You cannot list a copy without authorisation.	amazon.in search
Look up who owns the barcode	If your supplier gives you a GTIN, check which company it is licensed to. If that is not your supplier, the packaging may belong to another brand.	verify.gs1.org (replaced GEPIR in Jan 2024)
Search the name printed on the product	Not just <i>your</i> brand name — also whatever is already printed on the item.	ipindiaonline.gov.in
Ask the supplier in writing	“Is this unbranded/white-label, or does it carry a trademark I would need permission to resell?” Get it on the invoice, not in a chat.	Supplier
Reverse image search the photos	Catches suppliers passing off a copy of a branded item as “generic”.	Google Lens / TinEye

If it turns out to be branded

You have exactly two honest options: **(1)** get a Letter of Authorisation or a GST invoice from an authorised distributor and go through Amazon's approval process for that brand, or **(2)** source an unbranded version instead and avoid the problem. There is no third path where you quietly list someone else's brand.

17 · Compliance by Regulator

For your current Home & Kitchen product, only Chapter 7 labelling definitely applies — plus possibly EPR plastic (17.5). This chapter is for your **next** product.

17.1 BIS — Compulsory Registration Scheme

UNCONFIRMED Covers 400+ product categories: electronics and IT, electrical goods, steel, chemicals, food-contact equipment, textiles, toys, helmets, cement. It applies the moment you source anything electrical, electronic, or a toy with electronic parts.

UNCONFIRMED Penalties under the BIS Act, 2016: up to 2 years imprisonment or a ₹2,00,000 fine for a first offence, rising to 5 years and ₹5,00,000 for repeats. Marketplaces actively remove non-compliant listings when BIS issues enforcement notices.

Register before you source, not after. Portal: bis.gov.in

17.2 FSSAI — food, drink and supplements

The update most guides still miss

VERIFIED FSSAI raised the **Basic Registration threshold from ₹12 lakh to ₹1.5 crore** of annual turnover. State Licence now covers ₹1.5 crore to ₹50 crore. Central Licence applies above ₹50 crore. FSSAI also revised licence and registration **validity** at the same time.

Source: [BusinessWorld — FSSAI revises validity and raises turnover threshold](#)

The exception that overrides the thresholds

UNCONFIRMED Businesses **selling food online are widely reported to need a Central FSSAI Licence for their head office regardless of turnover**. If so — and it is consistent with how FSSAI treats e-commerce — a small Amazon food seller does **not** qualify for cheap Basic Registration just because revenue is low. This specific rule was not verified. **Verify it on FoSCoS before you ever list a food product**. Getting it wrong means operating without a valid licence.

UNCONFIRMED Penalties for operating without a valid licence: ₹2–5 lakh fine and up to 6 months imprisonment under Section 63 of the FSS Act. Applies to any food, drink or supplement — including home bakers and cloud kitchens.

Portal: foscoss.fssai.gov.in

17.3 CDSCO — medical devices

A rule often stated too strictly

You will often read that since 1 October 2023 **every** class needs a licence with no exemptions left. That is stricter than the actual law.

VERIFIED The move to licensing happened in stages: **Class A and B from 1 October 2022**, and **Class C and D from 1 October 2023**. And CDSCO's own FAQ notes an exception: **Class A non-sterile, non-measuring devices need only registration**, not a licence.

Sources: [CDSCO gazette summary](#) · [CDSCO Medical Devices FAQ](#)

Devices are graded A to D by risk under the Medical Device Rules, 2017.

UNCONFIRMED Foreign manufacturers cannot apply directly. An Indian Authorised Agent holding a wholesale drug licence files on their behalf using Form MD-14, and the licence is issued as Form MD-15 through the SUGAM portal. Government fees are reported at roughly \$1,000 for Class A, \$3,000 for Class B, and \$5,000 for Class C and D.

Practical advice: this is a heavy compliance load. If you ever add BP monitors, glucometers or thermometers, budget for a regulatory consultant rather than doing it yourself.

17.4 WPC — wireless devices (Bluetooth, Wi-Fi)

VERIFIED Bluetooth devices are **not exempt** from WPC Equipment Type Approval. But most consumer wireless accessories qualify for a much simpler **self-declaration** route through the Saral Sanchar portal, rather than the full licensing-office process.

VERIFIED The ETA fee is **₹10,000 per product** containing one or more RF modules.

Sources: [DoT — ETA FAQ \(fee\)](#) · [Customs public notice on ETA by self-declaration](#)

A detail often reported wrongly

Some guides list the excluded products as “drones and specialised cameras”. **VERIFIED** The actual excluded list is **radar, jammers, drones, and satellite equipment**. Cameras are not on it.

UNCONFIRMED Enforcement penalties have reportedly reached ₹50 lakh plus inventory seizure. Treat wireless compliance as a real risk, not a theoretical one.

17.5 EPR — plastic packaging

If you use poly bags, bubble wrap or shrink wrap — which you do, per Chapter 19 — you may fall under Extended Producer Responsibility, run by CPCB at eprplastic.cpcb.gov.in.

This one is genuinely unresolved

UNSETTLED Many guides state confidently that **micro and small brand owners are exempt**, citing a CPCB FAQ. Be careful with that.

There is a **2024 amendment to the Plastic Waste Management Rules** dealing specifically with the registration of micro and small producers and sellers — which points the other way. An older primary document does not automatically beat a newer one in a fast-moving area, so treat the exemption as unproven rather than settled.

See: [MPCB circular on registration of micro and small producers under PWM Rules 2024](#)

What to actually do: do not assume you are exempt. Check your Udyam classification, then confirm your position directly with CPCB or an environmental compliance consultant. This is a cheap question to ask and an expensive one to get wrong.

17.6 EPR — batteries

UNCONFIRMED The Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022 cover **all** battery types. Critically, “Producer” includes anyone selling a battery-containing product **under their own brand name** — not just the battery manufacturer. So if you ever private-label a power bank or a battery toy, you become a Producer.

UNCONFIRMED Registration is through CPCB's portal (eprbattery.cpcb.gov.in) using Form 1(A). No government fee for registration itself, but Producers must buy EPR certificates from registered recyclers in proportion to what they sell, at market-determined prices. Falling short triggers an Environmental Compensation penalty that you cannot settle later by buying certificates after the fact. Registration is valid 5 years.

17.7 Hallmarking — gold and silver

VERIFIED **Gold:** hallmarking is mandatory for gold jewellery and artefacts since **23 June 2021**, with **9-carat added from 1 July 2025**. Every piece needs a 6-digit HUID number generated at a BIS-registered centre before sale. Coverage has expanded in phases to **385 districts** as of the 2026 amendment.

Source: BIS — Hallmarking order, 2026 second amendment, 385 districts

Silver: the answer is “voluntary”

You will find credible-looking sources flatly contradicting each other on silver. The question is answerable.

VERIFIED Silver hallmarking is **voluntary**. A HUID-based voluntary system began on **1 September 2025** under revised standard **IS 2112:2025**, bringing silver in line with gold for traceability. BIS has said it is **planning a phased move toward making it mandatory**, but no date has been announced.

Sources: [Economic Times — voluntary silver hallmarking begins](#) · [ET Retail — BIS plans phased move to mandatory](#)

Sources claiming silver became mandatory in September 2025 are wrong — they confuse the start of the voluntary HUID system with a mandate.

17.8 Textiles and clothing labelling

UNCONFIRMED This is not a separate regulator — it is part of the same Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules, 2011 from Chapter 7. Pre-packed textiles need the standard declarations.

UNCONFIRMED Garments sold **loose** (folded on a shelf, not sealed) were historically outside Legal Metrology entirely. The Third Amendment Rules, 2022, effective **1 January 2023**, introduced a specific labelling requirement for loose garments: name and address of the manufacturer, marketer, brand owner or importer, country of origin, and size in international indicators (S/M/L/XL).

CHECK LIVE A draft regulation from the Textiles Committee was circulating in March 2026 that would add a more detailed textile-specific labelling regime. It was still a **draft**. Do not build compliance around a draft — but watch for it if you move into apparel.

17.9 DGFT — Import Export Code (IEC)

UNCONFIRMED An IEC is mandatory for **any** commercial import into India, whatever the shipment value. Exemptions are narrow: personal-use imports, government bodies, and small border trade. If you ever source from Alibaba or 1688 instead of a domestic supplier, you need one.

UNCONFIRMED Applied for on dgft.gov.in, costs ₹500 once, issued in about 1–3 working days, valid for life — **but every holder must complete an annual update between April and June**. Miss that window and the IEC is deactivated automatically until you reactivate it.

After you have the IEC, you also need to register your bank's AD Code at your import port and register on ICEGATE for customs filing. Both are one-time steps per port.

17.10 Amazon's own Hazmat programme

Separate from every government regulator above. Amazon independently classifies batteries, aerosols, flammables, chemicals and magnets as dangerous goods. **CHECK LIVE** Seller Central → Help → Hazmat.

17.11 Before you move on

- ☐ Correct regulator identified for *this specific product*, not the broad category
- ☐ Licence or registration obtained **before** placing a bulk order

- ☐ Import route confirmed — IEC needed only if sourcing from outside India
- ☐ Penalty exposure understood and compliance cost built into your margin sheet
- ☐ EPR plastic position confirmed (17.5) — do not assume exemption

18 · Finding and Vetting Suppliers

18.1 Where to look

Platform	Best for	Watch out for
IndiaMART	Domestic manufacturers and wholesalers, low minimum orders	Fastest place to start — no import paperwork. Quality varies hugely; always sample.
TradeIndia	Similar to IndiaMART	Good for comparing quotes across several domestic suppliers
Udaan	Domestic wholesale, including Home & Kitchen	Sign up with your GSTIN. Users report product mismatches and GST/HSN invoicing problems — check what arrives against what you ordered before reordering.
Alibaba	Overseas manufacturers, larger minimum orders	Adds import and customs compliance (17.9) on top of everything else
1688	Alibaba's China-domestic platform, often cheaper	Usually needs a sourcing agent. Not built for overseas buyers.
Factory visits / trade fairs	Highest trust, best for large orders	Worth it once volume justifies the travel

18.2 Words suppliers will use

Term	What it means
MOQ	Minimum Order Quantity — the smallest batch they will make or sell. Usually negotiable, especially for a trial.
OEM	They manufacture to <i>your</i> design and specification.
ODM	They already have a design; you customise branding or small features on top.
QC	Quality Control — inspection before shipping. Do it yourself, or hire an agency for larger orders.
Sampling	Ordering and physically testing one unit before committing to a bulk order.
Freight	Getting goods from supplier to you. Domestic is simple road freight; overseas adds sea or air freight plus customs.

18.3 Negotiation checklist

- ☐ Get quotes from **at least 3 suppliers** before committing
- ☐ Ask for MOQ flexibility on the first order — many will lower it for a trial run
- ☐ **Always order a sample**, even from a supplier you trust
- ☐ Confirm in writing who pays for freight
- ☐ Agree payment terms — part advance plus part on delivery is safer than full advance
- ☐ Ask directly whether the product already has a GS1 barcode, or whether you will need a GTIN exemption
- ☐ Get written confirmation the product carries no existing trademark (16.3)

Never pay 100% in advance to a new supplier

This is the single most common way new sellers lose their sourcing capital — regardless of how good the quoted price is. A supplier who refuses any part-payment structure on a first order is telling you something.

Domestic vs overseas — the real dividing line

Source domestically (IndiaMART, TradeIndia, Udaan, factory visits) and you stay inside the rules already covered in Chapters 5, 16 and 17. The moment you consider Alibaba, 1688 or any overseas supplier, you add **DGFT/IEC plus customs** to your checklist — before you send money.

19 • Packaging and Barcodes

19.1 Do you actually need to buy a barcode?

Two different barcodes matter, and people confuse them constantly.

Barcode	What it is	Do you need it?
GTIN (also called UPC or EAN)	A global product ID issued by GS1. Identifies the <i>product</i> worldwide.	Needed for most new listings — unless you get an exemption
FNSKU	Amazon's own internal barcode. Identifies <i>your</i> unit in <i>Amazon's</i> warehouse.	Always , on every FBA unit

- **If your product already has a manufacturer-issued GS1 barcode** — use it as-is. Do not create a new one.
- **If it is genuinely unbranded, handmade, private-label, or a bundle you made** — you likely qualify for a **GTIN exemption** and can skip buying a barcode.

UNCONFIRMED How the exemption works: it is granted per brand, per category — not account-wide. Apply during listing creation: Catalogue → Add Products → “I’m adding a product not sold on Amazon” → tick “I don’t have a Product ID” → submit your brand name plus 2–9 images showing all sides of the product and packaging. Review typically takes 48–72 hours.

One thing to think about before relying on exemption

A GTIN exemption is an **Amazon-only shortcut**, not a real product identity. If you ever plan to sell the same item on Flipkart, in physical shops, or export it, buy a proper GS1 India barcode instead.

Never buy a cheap barcode from an unofficial reseller. Amazon checks ownership against the GS1 database. A mismatched barcode gets your listing suppressed, and you will have paid for the privilege.

19.2 The FNSKU placement rule

You can print and apply FNSKU labels yourself, or pay Amazon a per-unit fee to do it (FBA Label Service).

The rule that gets inbound shipments rejected

Your FNSKU label must **not cover any Legal Metrology declaration** — not the manufacturer address, not the net quantity, not the MRP. Decide where the label goes **while designing your packaging artwork**. Discovering the clash after you have printed 5,000 poly bags is an expensive lesson.

19.3 Packaging by product type

Product type	What to use
Fragile, glass, ceramic	Bubble wrap plus a rigid outer carton, cushioning on all sides
Clothing and soft goods	Poly bag for moisture protection, inside a mailer or box
Coiled or flexible items — rope, cable (yours)	Poly bag or shrink wrap to stop tangling and abrasion in transit
Electronics	Anti-static bag, foam inserts, rigid box

Product type	What to use
Bulk cartons going to the FC	Master carton with a carton label showing contents, quantity and FNSKU/ASIN reference

19.4 Packaging is a fee lever, not a side cost

Every gram and centimetre feeds straight into your weight handling fee (8.4), pick & pack fee (8.5) and storage fee (8.6).

- **Use the smallest box that protects the product.** Empty space increases volumetric weight without protecting anything. Remember: $\text{length} \times \text{breadth} \times \text{height} \div 5000$.
- **Weigh and measure the finished parcel**, not the bare product. That is what Amazon bills against.
- **Compress or vacuum-pack** where the product allows it — this cuts both delivery and storage costs at once.
- **Re-measure after any packaging change.** A small increase in the longest side or girth can tip a product into the Heavy & Bulky tier, which changes both the delivery and pick & pack formulas.

20 · Returns and Getting Reimbursed

Returns hit your real margin harder than most sellers expect. A healthy-looking profit per unit can vanish in a category with a high return rate.

20.1 Return windows and refunds

UNCONFIRMED Return windows are set per product and category and are shown on the product page itself — for example “10 Days Returnable”. Most non-exempt categories fall in a 7–30 day window. Some categories are explicitly non-returnable.

A product is returnable within its window if it is damaged, has missing parts, is defective, or is materially different from the listing description.

UNCONFIRMED Amazon reportedly starts a refund once the item is received back at a fulfilment centre, and processes the refund request within 13 days of successful pickup. **CHECK LIVE** — I did not verify the 13-day figure.

20.2 What returns cost you

The asymmetry nobody explains up front

UNCONFIRMED On a return you typically get **most of the referral fee credited back — but not the weight handling fee or the pick & pack fee**. Those are gone. So a returned unit costs you the outbound delivery, the picking labour, and possibly a removal or disposal fee if it comes back unsellable.

This is why a 20% return rate is far worse than a 20% discount. Build a return allowance into your margin sheet (Chapter 11).

20.3 A-to-Z Guarantee

Covers customers on seller-fulfilled orders when a seller cannot resolve a missing, damaged or materially different item within 3 business days. Since you use FBA, Amazon handles the customer-facing return process directly — so this mainly matters if you ever add a Self-Ship or Easy Ship product.

20.4 SAFE-T claims — getting Amazon's own mistakes paid back

UNCONFIRMED SAFE-T claims let FBA sellers recover money when **Amazon's** handling causes the loss:

- Stock damaged or lost inside a fulfilment centre
- Stock lost in transit between fulfilment centres
- Customer returns processed incorrectly, or the wrong item taken back
- Stock disposed of incorrectly
- Fee and charge disputes

File from Seller Central against the relevant order or shipment, attaching shipment IDs, inventory records and photos. Typical review time is 3–7 business days, tracked in the SAFE-T Communication Center.

Amazon will not tell you when it owes you money

Check your **Inventory Adjustment Report** and **Reimbursements Report** every month. Look for entries flagged *Lost — Warehouse* or *Damaged — Warehouse* that have not been reimbursed. Nobody sends you a notification.

The distinction that decides your claim: “warehouse-damaged” is generally reimbursable. “customer-damaged” generally is not. Read the condition notes carefully before filing.

21 · Advertising (PPC)

Formulas are in Chapter 12. This chapter is about actually running a campaign.

21.1 The three ad types

Format	What it does	When to use it
Sponsored Products	Ads for a single product in search results and on product pages	Start here. This is the only one you need at first.
Sponsored Brands	Banner ads with your logo and several products	Needs Brand Registry. Later.
Sponsored Display	Follows shoppers who viewed but did not buy	Once you have enough traffic to retarget

21.2 How to structure your first campaign

1. **Start with Automatic targeting** for 1–2 weeks. Let Amazon find which search terms convert. You do not know yet, and guessing wastes money.
2. **Pull the Search Term Report.** This shows the actual words customers typed.
3. **Move the winners into a Manual campaign** using exact match, so you control the bid on terms you know work.
4. **Add the losers as Negative Keywords** in the automatic campaign to stop paying for them.
5. **Run both campaigns together.** Automatic keeps discovering; Manual controls bids on proven winners.

21.3 Match types

Type	Behaviour
Broad	Widest reach, least precise. Good for discovery, bad for tight budgets.
Phrase	Matches searches containing your phrase in order. Middle ground.
Exact	Only the precise keyword or very close variants. Most control — use for proven converters.

21.4 Budgeting against your margin

The one rule that keeps advertising from eating your business

Your target ACOS must sit below your margin after all Chapter 8 fees. If your net margin is 20% and your ACOS is 25%, you are paying ₹1.25 to earn ₹1.00. A great click-through rate does not fix that — it makes it worse, faster.

Watch TACOS over months, not ACOS over days. A campaign that is working shows organic sales rising and TACOS trending down over 2–3 months. If TACOS stays flat, your ads are renting sales rather than building a product.

CHECK LIVE Amazon's ad interface, bid strategies and placement settings change often. Look at Seller Central → Advertising → Campaign Manager for the current layout rather than expecting any book to match the screen.

22 · Building a Brand

Turning one product into something defensible. Right now, a Generic listing is not defensible — anyone can sell against it.

Step	What it involves	Needs Brand Registry?
Trademark (TM-A)	File Form TM-A on the IP India portal	No — this comes first
Brand Registry	Enrol using your trademark	—
Logo and packaging	One consistent look across all your products	No
Insert cards	A small card in the parcel — thank-you note, care instructions, or a QR code	No
A+ Content	Rich images and comparison charts on your listing	Yes
Brand Store	A free multi-page mini-site inside Amazon	Yes
Amazon Vine	Gives products to trusted reviewers for honest reviews — the cheapest legitimate way off zero reviews	Yes
Social media	Not required to sell, but builds trust off-platform	No

22.1 The right order for a one-product seller

1. **File TM-A now.** It is cheap and unlocks everything downstream. Do not wait until you have three products.
2. **Design one logo and packaging treatment before your next order**, so it can be reused instead of redesigned per product.
3. **Add an insert card to your current rope packaging.** Near-zero cost, and your cheapest lever for both reviews and repeat visibility.
4. **Hold off on Brand Store, A+ Content and heavy social spend** until Brand Registry is actually active. Building them earlier just means rebuilding them.

What an insert card may not say

Ask for a review, by all means. **Do not offer anything in exchange for a positive review** — no discount, no gift, no refund. That violates Amazon policy and risks your account. “If you have a moment, we’d appreciate an honest review” is fine. Anything conditional on the rating is not.

23 · Worked Case Studies

Three price points. Referral percentages are real. Product cost, packaging and weight are illustrative — swap in your own. **Read the warning on closing fees before trusting cases 2 and 3.**

Closing fees above ₹500 are included here

VERIFIED Many guides claim no closing fee applies above ₹500. It does — **₹27** for ₹501–1,000 and **₹52** above ₹1,000 on FBA. Both figures are included below. Leaving them out overstates profit on every higher-priced product.

Case 1 — a ₹300 kitchen storage container (FBA)

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Selling price	₹300	—
Referral fee — Kitchen, under ₹1,000	₹0	VERIFIED 0% band
Closing fee — Group A, ₹0–300	₹20	UNCONFIRMED
Weight handling — 300 g, Regional, Standard STEP	₹39	VERIFIED rate
Pick & pack — standard, under 1 kg	₹17	UNCONFIRMED
GST at 18% on (₹20 + ₹30 + ₹17)	≈₹12	Calculated
Product cost	₹110	Illustrative
Packaging	₹8	Illustrative
Net profit	≈₹103	≈34% margin

Note: the ₹17 pick & pack fee is easy to leave out of this kind of calculation. It applies to every FBA unit sold, so it is included here.

Case 2 — a ₹1,200 charging cable (FBA)

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Selling price	₹1,200	—
Referral fee — Cables & Adapters, 20% above ₹1,000	₹240	UNCONFIRMED (Appendix A)
Closing fee — above ₹1,000	₹52	VERIFIED
Weight handling — 150 g, National, Standard STEP	₹65	VERIFIED rate
Pick & pack	₹17	UNCONFIRMED
GST at 18% on (₹240 + ₹52 + ₹65 + ₹17)	≈₹67	Calculated
Product cost	₹350	Illustrative
Packaging	₹15	Illustrative
Net profit	≈₹394	≈33% margin

What this case teaches: above ₹1,000, the **referral fee becomes the dominant cost** — ₹240 here, more than five times the delivery fee. At low prices the flat fees dominate; at high prices the percentage does. That flip changes which products are worth selling.

Case 3 — a ₹5,000 side table (FBA, Heavy & Bulky)

Line item	Amount	Confidence
Selling price	₹5,000	—
Referral fee — Furniture-Other, 15.5% (₹1,000–15,000)	₹775	UNCONFIRMED
Closing fee — above ₹1,000	₹52	VERIFIED
Weight handling — Heavy & Bulky, National, first 12 kg, Standard STEP	₹300	VERIFIED rate
Pick & pack — Heavy & Bulky up to 12 kg	₹26	UNCONFIRMED
GST at 18% on (₹775 + ₹52 + ₹300 + ₹26)	≈₹208	Calculated
Product cost	₹2,200	Illustrative
Packaging and crating	₹150	Illustrative
Net profit	≈₹1,289	≈26% margin

What this case teaches: furniture crosses the Heavy & Bulky threshold, which changes *both* the delivery and pick & pack formulas. Always check the size tier before assuming standard rates — especially above about ₹3,000, where furniture and appliances live.

24 · Risks Nobody Warns You About

Everything before this chapter is procedure. This chapter is about what actually decides whether a seller survives year one.

24.1 Cash on Delivery and failed deliveries (RTO)

RTO means Return to Origin — the parcel goes out, the customer refuses it or is unreachable, and it comes back. It is the most India-specific risk in this book.

Treat these as estimates, not facts

These figures circulate widely: COD is 60–65% of Indian e-commerce orders, of which 25–30% fail to deliver, versus under 3% for prepaid. **The source chain is blog-to-blog, not primary**, and COD's share has been falling as UPI adoption grows — so 60–65% is likely high for 2026.

The *direction* is right and worth acting on: COD orders fail far more often than prepaid ones, and faster delivery reduces failures. The precise percentages are not planning-grade numbers.

What this means for you as an FBA seller

- **Good news:** Amazon handles the courier and the cash collection. You are not chasing addresses or reconciling cash.
- **Bad news:** a refused COD order is still a lost sale, and the unit needs re-inspection before it can be sold again.

The habit this should change

When you forecast revenue or plan a reorder, use **confirmed delivered** numbers from your reports — not “orders placed”. Orders-placed overstates real demand. Ordering stock against that inflated figure is one of the most common and most expensive first-year mistakes.

24.2 Scams aimed at sellers

- **Refund abuse.** A buyer arranges a partial refund while keeping the product — by returning an empty box, swapping a tracking ID, or claiming the item was lost. **Photograph and video every outbound parcel** so you have evidence if a return does not match what you sent.
- **“Guaranteed ranking” and review-selling agencies.** Anyone offering to put you on page 1 or supply a batch of 5-star reviews is selling an Amazon policy violation. The realistic outcome is suspension, not growth. Real ranking comes from Chapter 21 and genuine reviews.
- **Supplier fraud.** Never wire 100% advance to a new, unverified supplier — see 18.3.

If you are defrauded: National Cyber Crime Helpline **1930**, or cybercrime.gov.in

24.3 What year one actually looks like

Phase	Normal	Warning sign
Month 1–2	Break-even or a small loss while you learn fulfilment, fix listing problems and collect first reviews	Zero sales after 4+ weeks with steady ad spend — revisit the product and listing, do not just wait

Phase	Normal	Warning sign
Month 3–4	First real profit signal, if margin and demand were validated properly	Margin still negative after fees — the product may simply not be viable. No amount of advertising fixes bad unit economics.
Month 6+	Reinvestment decisions: more products, Brand Registry, or scaling ads	Scaling ad spend on a product with no organic pull — this amplifies a loser faster

24.4 The most common avoidable mistakes

- **Over-ordering on an unproven product** because the MOQ discount looked good. Test small. With the aged-stock surcharge now starting at 181 days (8.6), dead stock costs more than it used to.
- **Competing purely on price** against established listings — a race you lose to sellers with better supplier terms and Buy Box history.
- **Spreading across too many products** before any one is profitable. Depth before breadth for the first few months.
- **Ignoring Account Health** until it becomes a suspension. Check weekly.
- **Treating the first bad review as a crisis** instead of as information. Read it for a genuine product or listing fix.
- **Trusting a static document over Fee Preview.** Including this one.

24.5 Festive season planning

India's big sale events drive a disproportionate share of annual volume, Home & Kitchen included. The principle that matters more than any specific date: **place inventory orders 6–8 weeks before a major sale event, not during it.** Supplier lead times and Amazon's inbound processing both slow down when everyone rushes at once.

CHECK LIVE Exact event dates move every year. Check Seller Central → Growth → Deals, or Announcements, 2–3 months ahead.

25 · Growth Roadmap

Phase	When	Focus
1	Month 1–2	Stabilise your first product — reviews, reliable fulfilment, account health. Fix the TCS figure in your records. Confirm your fee category.
2	Month 2–4	Add 2–3 products in the same open category. File TM-A if you have not.
3	Month 5–8	Apply for Brand Registry once you have a trademark and 3+ differentiated products.
4	Month 8+	Consider one adjacent gated category. Reinvest profit before scaling ad spend.

File the trademark early

Full trademark registration takes a long time, but you do not need to wait for it to start using the name and building the brand. **UNCONFIRMED** Brand Registry reportedly accepts a pending TM-A application number — confirm this in the enrolment flow. Either way, filing in month 1 costs little and removes a bottleneck later.

Appendix A · Referral Fee Table, by Category

All **219 fee categories** Amazon publishes, in Amazon's own order. The referral fee is identical whichever fulfilment channel you use — only closing fee and weight handling change by channel.

Every row here was read from the live page

VERIFIED This entire table was extracted directly from sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing on **4 August 2026** — all 219 categories and 503 individual price rules, not a summary.

Rates effective: Amazon's 16 March 2026 update. Two categories had a scheduled mid-year change; where that applies, the expired rate is ~~struck through~~ and the rate **in force now** is shown in bold.

Automotive, Car & Accessories **VERIFIED**

Category	Referral fee
Automotive - Helmets & Riding Gloves	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8.5% > ₹1,000
Automotive - Tyres & Rims	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 3% > ₹1,000 (Until June 9, 2026 — expired) 0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7% > ₹1,000 (From June 10, 2026 — in force now)
Automotive Vehicles - 2-Wheelers, 4-Wheelers and Electric Vehicles	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% ₹1,000–50,000 · 2% > ₹50,000
Automotive – Car and Bike parts, Brakes, Styling and body fittings, Transmission, Engine parts, Exhaust systems, Interior fitting, Suspension and Wipers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000
Automotive – Cleaning kits (Sponges, Brush, Duster, Cloths and liquids), Car interior & exterior care (Waxes, polish, Shampoo and other), Car and Bike Lighting and Paints	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13% > ₹1,000
Automotive Accessories (Floor Mats, Seat/Car/Bike Covers) and Riding Gear (Face Covers and Gloves)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14% > ₹1,000
Vehicle Tools and Appliances	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8.5% > ₹1,000
Oils, Lubricants	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Automotive – Batteries and air fresheners	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8.5% > ₹1,000
Car Electronics Devices	0% ≤ ₹300 · 7.5% ₹300–500 · 9.5% ₹500–1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Car Cradles, Lens Kits & Tablet Cases	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 28.5% > ₹1,000
Car Electronics Accessories	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 15% > ₹1,000
Automotive - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000

Baby, Toys & Education **VERIFIED**

Category	Referral fee
Toys - Drones	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 30% > ₹1,000
Toys - Party Supplies, Balloons, Banners, Masks, Confetti, Birthday Celebration	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Toys - Games and Puzzles, Boards Games, Adult Games and Building Sets	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Toys - Infant and Pre-school Toys (Electronic and Non-Electronic)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Toys - Outdoor, Activity and Sports Toys	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10.5% > ₹1,000
Toys - Plush Toys, Action Figures and Dolls	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10.5% > ₹1,000
Toys - Remote and Non-Remote Controlled Vehicles and Vehicle Sets	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Toys - STEM, Art and Craft, Learning and Development Toys	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Baby Hardlines - Swings, Bouncers and Rockers, Carriers, Walkers, Baby Safety - Guards and Locks, Baby Room Décor, Baby Furniture, Baby Car Seats and Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6.5% > ₹1,000
Baby Strollers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9% > ₹1,000
Baby and Kids-Furniture and Home Décor	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8.5% > ₹1,000
Baby-Walker	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000
Baby - Diapers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9.5% > ₹1,000
Toys - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Baby - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Breast pumps	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Diaper bags	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000

Books, Music, Movies & Video Games VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Books	0% ≤ ₹250 · 2% ₹250–500 · 4% ₹500–1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
School Textbook Bundles	2% ≤ ₹250 · 3% ₹250–1,000 · 4% ₹1,000–1,500 · 4.5% > ₹1,500
Video Games - Consoles	7% ≤ ₹500 · 5% ₹500–1,000 · 9% > ₹1,000
Video Games - Accessories	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
Video Games - Online Game Services	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 2% ₹1,000–2,000 · 3% > ₹2,000
Movies	6.5% ≤ ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 6.5% > ₹1,000
Music	6.5% ≤ ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 6.5% > ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - DJ & VJ Equipment, Recording and Computer, Cables & Leads, PA & Stage	6% ≤ ₹300 · 4.5% ₹300–500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 11% > ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Microphones	9.5% ≤ ₹300 · 0% ₹300–1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Keyboards	8% ≤ ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Guitars	10% ≤ ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Musical Instruments - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11% > ₹1,000
Video Games - Other products	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000

Industrial, Medical, Scientific & Office VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Masks	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
3D Printers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Business and Industrial Supplies - Scientific Supplies	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 7% > ₹15,000

Category	Referral fee
Business & Industrial Supplies - Commercial, Food Handling Equipment and Health Supplies	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5.5% > ₹1,000
Business and Industrial Supplies - Electrical Testing, Dimensional Measurement, Thermal Printers, Barcode Scanners	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% > ₹1,000
Power & Hand Tools and Water Dispensers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Stethoscopes	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10.5% > ₹1,000
Packing materials	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000
Office products - Office supplies	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13% > ₹1,000
Office products - Electronic Devices	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Office products - Arts and Crafts	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000
Office products - Writing Instruments	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14% > ₹1,000
Office Furniture - Study Table, Office and Gaming Chairs	16.5% ≤ ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 15.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 11% > ₹15,000
Office - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Business & Industrial Supplies - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% ₹1,000–15,000 · 5% > ₹15,000

Clothing, Fashion, Jewellery, Luggage & Shoes VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Apparel - Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Sweat Shirts and Jackets	18% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Shorts	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 24% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Baby	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Ethnic wear	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16.5% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Other innerwear	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 18.5% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Sleepwear	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Sarees and Dress Materials	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Men's T-shirts (except Polos, Tank tops and full sleeve tops)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 23% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Women's Innerwear and Lingerie	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 18% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Dress	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Shirts	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 21% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Socks and Stockings	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Thermals	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000
Pants - Trousers, Jeans, Trackpants and Leggings	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000
Backpacks, Laptop Sleeves and Bags	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14.5% > ₹1,000
Eyewear - Sunglasses, Frames and zero power eye glasses	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 18.5% > ₹1,000
Fashion Jewellery	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 22.5% > ₹1,000
Fine Jewellery - Gold Coins	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% > ₹1,000
Fine Jewellery - studded	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13% > ₹1,000
Fine Jewellery - unstudded and solitaire	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000

Category	Referral fee
Silver Jewellery	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13% > ₹1,000
Silver Coins & Bars	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% > ₹1,000
Handbags	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Luggage - Suitcase & Trolleys	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5.5% > ₹1,000
Luggage - Travel Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Flip Flops, Fashion Sandals and Slippers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15% > ₹1,000
Kids shoes	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000
Shoes	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Wallets	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14% > ₹1,000
Watches	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15% > ₹1,000
Luggage - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Apparel - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 19% > ₹1,000

Electronics, Cameras, Mobile & PC VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Camera Lenses	7% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Camera and Camcorder	5% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7% ₹1000–19,000 · 9% ₹19,000–49000 · 7% > ₹49000
Camera Accessories	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
Cases, Covers and Skins, and Screen Guards	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 25% > ₹1,000
Accessories - Electronics, PC and Wireless	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 17% > ₹1,000
Electronic Devices (except TV, Camera & Camcorder, Camera Lenses and Accessories, GPS Devices, Speakers)	9% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11% > ₹1,000
GPS Devices	13.5% ≤ ₹300 · 12.5% ₹300–500 · 13.5% > ₹500
Hard Disks	9.5% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Headsets, Headphones and Earphones	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 18% > ₹1,000
Keyboards and Mouse	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 17% > ₹1,000
Laptop and Camera Battery	14% ≤ ₹300 · 12.5% ₹300–500 · 14% ₹500–1,000 · 15.5% > ₹1,000
Monitors	6.5% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Tablets (including Graphic Tablets)	0% ≤ ₹300 · 6% ₹300–12,000 · 10% > ₹12,000
Scanners and Printers	9% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10.5% > ₹1,000
Memory Cards	16% ≤ ₹500 · 5% ₹500–1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000
Speakers	11% ≤ ₹500 · 11.5% ₹500–1000 · 14% > ₹1000
Power Banks and Chargers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 20.5% > ₹1,000
Smart Watches and Accessories	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5% ₹300–1,000 · 17% > ₹1,000
PC Components - RAM and Motherboards	0% ≤ ₹300 · 5.5% > ₹300
Entertainment Collectibles	13% ≤ ₹300 · 17% > ₹300
Software products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% ₹1,000–2,000 · 9.5% > ₹2,000
Cables and Adapters - Electronics, PC and Wireless	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 20% > ₹1,000

Grocery, Food & Pet Supplies VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Grocery - Herbs and Spices	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Grocery - Dried fruits and nuts	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9% > ₹1,000
Grocery - Hampers and gifting	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11.5% > ₹1,000
Grocery & Gourmet - Oils	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000
Grocery and Gourmet - Beverages	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Pet Foods	0% ≤ ₹300 · 6.5% ₹300–1,000 · 9.5% > ₹1,000
Pet - Aquatics Supplies	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14% > ₹1,000
Pet Accessories including Apparel, Collar, Leash and Harness	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Pet comforters including Bed, Feeder, Cages, Carriers, Crates, Kennels and Doors	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Pet Essentials including Health Care, Grooming Aids, Shower and Bath Supplies, Supplements and Vitamins, Tick and Flea Control, Dental Care	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14% > ₹1,000
Grocery and Gourmet - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9% > ₹1,000
Pet - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000

Health, Beauty & Personal Care VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Personal Care Appliances - Weighing Scales and Fat Analyzers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
Beauty - Fragrance	0% ≤ ₹500 · 14% ₹500–1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Beauty - Haircare, Bath and Shower	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Beauty - Makeup	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7% > ₹1,000
Luxury Beauty	0% ≤ ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Face Wash	0% ≤ ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 9.5% > ₹1,000
Moisturizer cream	0% ≤ ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 9.5% > ₹1,000
Sunscreen	0% ≤ ₹500 · 9% ₹500–1,000 · 9.5% > ₹1,000
Facial steamers	0% ≤ ₹500 · 7% > ₹500
Personal Care Appliances - Grooming and Styling	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9.5% > ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Massagers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14.5% > ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Glucometer and Glucometer Strips	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5.5% > ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Thermometers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10.5% > ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Blood Pressure Monitors	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Pain Relief Devices (Electric Heating Pads, Electric Hot Water Bags, EMS, Tens)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Personal Care Appliances - Electric Tooth brush, Oral Irrigators and Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Health and Household - Sports Nutrition and Meal Replacement Shakes	0% ≤ ₹300 · 9% ₹300–500 · 9.5% > ₹500

Category	Referral fee
Health and Household - Medical Equipment, Sexual Wellness, Adult Incontinence, Elderly Care	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 2% > ₹1,000
Health and Household - Ayurvedic, Homeopathic and Alternate Medicine products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7% > ₹1,000
Health and Household - Household Cleaning, Laundry, Air Fresheners, Personal Hygiene (Hand Wash)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Feminine Hygiene and Care	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Health and Household - Vitamins & Mineral Health Supplements	0% ≤ ₹300 · 9% ₹300–500 · 10.5% ₹500–1,000 · 11% > ₹1,000
Body Support - Wearables and Soft Aids	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 2% > ₹1,000
OTC Medicine	12% ≤ ₹500 · 15% > ₹500
Beauty - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹500 · 9% > ₹500
Health and Household - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹300 · 11.5% > ₹300
Personal Care Appliances - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Health and Household – Regulated Healthcare: Menstrual Cups, Contact Lenses, Diagnostic Kits, Pain Relief	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 2% > ₹1,000

Home, Décor, Home Improvement, Furniture, Garden VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Bean Bags & Inflatables	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Rugs and Doormats	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9% > ₹1,000
Mattresses	25.5% ≤ ₹500 · 0% ₹500–1,000 · 16% ₹1,000–20,000 · 13.5% > ₹20,000
Clocks	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Wall Art	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
Home Fragrance and Candles	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Home furnishing (Excluding curtain and curtain accessories)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11% > ₹1,000
Home improvement - Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
Tiles & Flooring Accessories	0% ≤ ₹300 · 8% > ₹300
Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, adhoc usage)	0% ≤ ₹300 · 10% > ₹300
Home Storage (Excluding Kitchen Containers, Boxes, Bottles, and Kitchen Storage)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15% > ₹1,000
Home Improvement - Wallpapers and Wallpaper Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6.5% > ₹1,000
Home Decor Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 17% > ₹1,000
Wall Paints and Tools	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% > ₹1,000
Home - Waste & Recycling	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Craft materials	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000
Water Purifier and Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 7.5% > ₹5,000
Water Heaters and Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% ₹1,000–5,000 · 9% > ₹5,000

Category	Referral fee
Home improvement - Kitchen & Bath (Fittings, accessories), Cleaning Supplies, Electricals, Hardware, Building Materials	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Sanitaryware - Toilets, Bathtubs, Basins/Sinks, Bath Mirrors & Vanities, and Shower Enclosures/partitions	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% ₹1,000–10,000 · 6% > ₹10,000
Home Safety and Security Systems	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% > ₹1,000
Inverter and Batteries	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 4.5% > ₹1,000
Cleaning and Home Appliances	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8.5% > ₹5,000
Ladders	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Indoor Lighting – Wall, ceiling fixture lights, lamp bases, lamp shades and Smart Lighting	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Doors and Windows (wooden, metal, PVC/UPVC Doors & Windows)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% ₹1,000–5,000 · 2% > ₹5,000
LED Bulbs and Battens	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 14% > ₹1,000
Cushion Covers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10% > ₹1,000
Curtains and Curtain Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16.5% > ₹1,000
Slipcovers and Kitchen Linens	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15.5% > ₹1,000
Safes and Lockers with Locking Mechanism	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Solar Panels	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 2% > ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Leaf blower and Water pump	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6.5% > ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden- Chemical Pest Control, Bird control, Plant protection, Foggers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 9% > ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Solar Devices (Panels, Inverters, Charge controller, Battery, Lights, Solar gadgets)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8% > ₹1,000
Lawn and Garden - Plants, Seeds, Bulbs and Gardening Tools	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 11% > ₹1,000
Lawn & Garden - Outdoor equipments (Saws, Lawn Mowers, Cultivator, Tiller, String Trimmers, Water Pumps, Generators, Barbeque Grills, Greenhouses)	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6.5% > ₹1,000
Furniture - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 11% > ₹15,000
Lawn and Garden - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 10% ₹1,000–15,000 · 5% > ₹15,000
Home - other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 18% > ₹1,000
Home improvement - other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13.5% > ₹1,000
Indoor Lighting - Others	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000
Large Furniture - Sofa, Beds, Wardrobes, Recliners, Living & Dining room chairs and tables	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 15.5% ₹1,000–15,000 · 11% > ₹15,000
Netting Cover	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5% > ₹1,000
Shelves, Cabinets, Racks & Item Stands	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13% > ₹1,000

Kitchen & Appliances VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Kitchen - Glassware & Ceramicware	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Kitchen - Gas Stoves & Pressure Cookers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% ₹1,000–1,500 · 10% > ₹1,500

Category	Referral fee
Containers, Boxes, Bottles, and Kitchen Storage	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% > ₹1,000
Cookware, Tableware & Dinnerware	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Kitchen Tools & Supplies - Choppers, Knives, Bakeware & Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000
Major Appliances Accessories	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000
Small Appliances	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 4.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8% > ₹5,000
Fans and Robotic Vacuums	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 4.5% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8% > ₹5,000 (Until June 9, 2026 — expired) 0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7% ₹1,000–5,000 · 8% > ₹5,000 (From June 10, 2026 — in force now)
Kitchen - Other Products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12.5% > ₹1,000

Sports & Gym VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Bicycles	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 6% > ₹1,000
Gym Equipments	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 12% ₹1,000–35,000 · 10% > ₹35,000
Sports - Footwear	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 16% > ₹1,000
Sports - Cricket and Badminton Equipments, Tennis, Table Tennis, Squash, Football, Volleyball, Basketball, Throwball and Swimming	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8.5% > ₹1,000
Sports - Cricket Bats, Badminton Racquets, Tennis Racquets, Pickleball Paddles, Squash Racquets and TT Tables	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 7.5% > ₹1,000
Sports Collectibles	0% ≤ ₹300 · 17% > ₹300
Sports - Other products	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 13% > ₹1,000
Gym Weights	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 5.5% > ₹1,000

Other categories VERIFIED

Category	Referral fee
Deodorants	0% ≤ ₹500 · 6.5% ₹500–1,000 · 7% > ₹1,000
Bedsheets, Blankets and covers	0% ≤ ₹1,000 · 8.5% > ₹1,000
Coin Collectibles	0% ≤ ₹300 · 15% > ₹300
Warranty Services	10% ≤ ₹300 · 29% ₹300–500 · 30% > ₹500

Amazon's own disclaimer, in plain words

Amazon states on its fee page that some fee changes apply only to selected categories and to products in the ₹0–500 average-selling-price band, and that **Amazon may determine, change, reduce or increase any of these fees at its sole discretion, at any time**. No printed table is a contract. Re-check every six months.

Appendix B · Closing Fee Groups

Below ₹500, your closing fee depends which of **three tiers** your fee category sits in. From ₹501 upward the tiers stop mattering — every category pays the same.

Verified from the live page

VERIFIED The tier rates come from Amazon's own closing-fee rate card, and the **231 category assignments** below were extracted from the live fee page on **4 August 2026**.

Tier	₹0-300	₹301-500	Categories
Standard Fee tier	₹26 (Group #)	₹22 (Group ##)	153 categories
Select categories — tier 1	₹20 (Group A)	₹18 (Group C)	58 categories
Select categories — tier 2	₹13 (Group B)	₹14 (Group D)	20 categories
₹501-1,000 — all categories			₹27
Above ₹1,000 — all categories			₹52, or ₹72 for select categories

Standard Fee tier — ₹26 at ₹0-300 (Group #) · ₹22 at ₹301-500 (Group ##) **VERIFIED**

The default tier. Most categories sit here, and it is the most expensive. 153 categories.

Apparel · Baby · Apparel · Dress · Apparel · Ethnic Wear · Apparel · Shirts · Apparel · Socks & Stockings · Apparel · Thermals · Automotive · Batteries and Air fresheners · Automotive · Car and Bike parts, Brakes, Styling and body fittings, Transmission, Engine parts, Exhaust systems, Interior fitting, Suspension and Wipers · Baby & kids-Furniture and home decor · Baby · Diapers · Baby · Other Products · Baby Hardlines · Swings, Bouncers and Rockers, Carriers, Walkers Baby Safety · Guards & Locks Baby Room Decor Baby Furniture Baby Car Seats & Accessories · Baby Strollers · Baby-Walker · Backpacks · Bean bags & inflatables · Beauty · Haircare, Bath & Shower · Beauty · Make-up · Bedsheets, Blankets and Covers · Bicycles · Body Support · Wearables & Soft Aids · Breast pumps · Camera & Camcorder · Camera Accessories · Camera Lenses · Car Cradles, Lens Kits and Tablet Cases · Car Electronics Accessories · Car Electronics Devices · Chimneys · Cleaning and Home Appliances · Clocks · Coins Collectibles · Cushion Covers · Desktops · Diaper bags · Doors and Windows (wooden, metal, PVC/UPVC Doors & Windows) · Electronic Devices (Excluding TV, Camera & Camcorder, Camera Lenses & Accessories, GPS Devices, Speakers) · Face Wash · Facial Steamers · Fans and Robotic Vacuums · Feminine Hygiene and Care · Flipflops · GPS Devices · Gas Stoves and Pressure Cookers · Glassware and Ceramicware · Grocery and Gourmet · Beverages · Grooming and Styling · Guitars · Gym Equipment · Gym Weights · Handbags · Hard Disks · Headphones · Health and Household · Other Products · Health and Household · Sports Nutrition and meal replacement shakes · Health and Household – Regulated Healthcare Menstrual Cups, Contact Lenses, Diagnostic Kits, Pain Relief · Home Entertainment Others · Home Safety & Security Systems · Home furnishing (Excluding Curtain and Curtain Accessories) · Inverter and Batteries · Keyboards · Keyboards & Mouses · Kid Shoes · Kitchen & Bath (Fittings, accessories), Cleaning Supplies, Electricals, Hardware, Building Materials · Kitchen · Containers and Storage · Kitchen · Cookware, Tableware & Dinnerware · Kitchen · Other Products · Kitchen · Tools, Supplies & Accessories · Landline Phones

· Laptop Sleeves and Bags · Laptop and Camera Battery · Laptops · Large Appliances · Refrigerators · Large Furniture · Sofa, Beds, Wardrobes, Recliners, Living & Dining room chairs and tables · Lawn and Garden · Outdoor equipment, mowers and power tools · Luxury Beauty · Major Appliances · Other Products · Major appliance accessories · Mattresses · Memory Cards · Mobile Phones · Modems & Networking Devices · Moisturizer cream · Monitors · Movies · Music · Musical Instruments · DJ & VJ Equipment, Recording and Computer, Cables & Leads, PA & Stage · Musical Instruments · Microphones · Musical Instruments · Other Products · NETTING COVER · OTC Medicine · Office Furniture · study table, office and Gaming chairs · Office Products · Arts and Crafts · Office Products · Writing Instruments · Other · Furniture · PC Components · RAM & Motherboards · Pants · Trousers, Jeans, Trackpants & leggings · Pen Drives · Personal Care Appliances · Blood Pressure Monitors · Personal Care Appliances · Electric Massagers · Personal Care Appliances · Electric Pain Relief Devices (Electric Heating Pads, Electric Hot Water Bags, EMS, Tens) · Personal Care Appliances · Electric Tooth brush, Oral Irrigators & Accessories · Personal Care Appliances · Glucometer and Glucometer Strips · Personal Care Appliances · Other Products · Personal Care Appliances · Thermometers · Personal Care Appliances · Weighing Scales and Fat Analyzers · Pet · Aquatics Supplies · Pet Accessories including Apparel, Collar, Leash & Harness · Pet Food · Pet comforters including Bed, Feeder, Cages, Carriers, Crates, Kennels & Doors · Pet essentials including Health Care, Grooming Aids, Shower & Bath Supplies, Supplements & Vitamins, Tick & Flea Control, Dental Care · Power Banks & Chargers · Power, Hand Tool and Water Dispenser · Prescription Medicines · Projectors, Home Theatre Systems, Binoculars and Telescopes · Safes and Lockers · Sanitaryware · Toilets, Bathtubs, Basins/Sinks, Bath Mirrors & Vanities, and Shower Enclosures/partitions · Scanners and Printers · School Textbook Bundles · Shelves, Cabinets, Racks & Item Stands · Shoes · Small Appliances · Smart Watches and Accessories · Speakers · Sports ·

Cricket Bats, Badminton Racquets, Tennis Racquets, Pickleball Paddles, Squash Racquets and TT Tables · Sports - Cricket and Badminton Equipment, Tennis, Table Tennis, Squash, Football, Volleyball, Basketball, Throwball, Swimming · Sports - Footwear · Sports - Other Products · Sports Collectibles · Stethoscope · Suitcase & Trolleys · Sunscreen · Tablets · Televisions · Tiles & Flooring Accessories · Toys - Drones · Toys - Games & Puzzles, Boards Games, Adult Games and Construction Toys · Toys - Infant and Pre-school Toys (Electronic and Non-Electronic) · Toys - Outdoor, Activity and

Sports Toys · Toys - Plush Toys, Action Figures and Dolls · Toys - Remote and Non-Remote-Controlled Vehicles & Vehicle Sets · Toys - STEM, Art and Craft, learning and development Toys · Travel Accessories · Video Games - Online game services · Video Games - Other Products · Video Games Accessories · Video Games Consoles · Vitamins & Mineral Health Supplements · Warranty · Watches · Water Heaters and Accessories · Water Purifier and Accessories · Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)

Select categories — tier 1 — ₹20 at ₹0–300 (Group A) · ₹18 at ₹301–500 (Group C)

VERIFIED

A cheaper tier. **Your Home / Home Improvement categories are in this tier.** 58 categories.

3D Printer · Accessories - Electronics, PC and Wireless · Apparel - Men's T-shirts (except Tank tops and full sleeve tops) · Apparel - Other products · Apparel - Shorts · Apparel - Sweat Shirts and Jackets · Apparel Accessories · Apparel Other Innerwear · Apparel - Women's Innerwear and Lingerie · Automotive - Helmets and Riding Gloves · Automotive - Oils, Lubricants · Automotive - Other Products · Automotive - Tyres and Rims · Automotive Accessories - Floor Mats, Seat, Car and Bike Covers · Automotive Vehicles - 2-Wheelers, 4-Wheelers and Electric Vehicle · Beauty - Other Products · Business & Industrial Supplies - Commercial, Food Handling Equipment, and Health Supplies · Business & Industrial Supplies - Electrical Testing, Dimensional Measurement, Thermal Printers, Barcode Scanners · Business & Industrial Supplies - Other Products · Business & Scientific Supplies · Cases, Covers, Skins & Screen Guards · Craft Materials · Curtains and Curtain Accessories · Deodorants · Eyewear - Sunglasses, Frames and Zero Power Eye Glasses · Fragrance · Home - Other Products · Home - Waste and Recycling · Home Decor Products · Home Fragrance and Candles · Home Improvement

Accessories · Home Storage (Excluding Kitchen Containers, Boxes, Bottles, and Kitchen Storage) · Home improvement - Other Products · Home improvement - Wallpapers & Wallpaper Accessories · Indoor Lighting - Wall, ceiling fixture lights, lamp bases, lamp shades and Smart Lighting · LED Bulbs and Battens · Ladders · Lawn & Garden - Leaf blower and Water pump · Lawn & Garden - Other Products · Lawn & Garden - Solar Panels · Lawn and Garden - Chemical Pest Control, Mosquito Nets, Bird Control, Plant Protection, Foggers · Lawn and Garden - Plants, Seeds, Bulbs, and Gardening Tools · Lawn and Garden - Solar Devices, Inverters, Charge Controller, Battery, Lights, Solar Gadgets · Masks · Medical Equipment, Sexual Wellness, Adult Incontinence, Elderly Care · Office - Electronic Devices · Office - Other Products · Office Products - Office Supplies · Other Indoor Lighting · Packing Materials · Pet - Other Products · Rugs and Doormats · Sleepwear · Slipcovers and Kitchen Linens · Software Products · Vehicle Tools and Appliances · Wall Art · Wall Paints and Tools

Select categories — tier 2 — ₹13 at ₹0–300 (Group B) · ₹14 at ₹301–500 (Group D)

VERIFIED

The cheapest tier at ₹0–300. Note it is the only tier where the ₹301–500 rate is *higher* than the ₹0–300 rate. 20 categories.

Apparel - Sarees and Dress Materials · Books · Cables and Adapters - Electronics, Computers and Wireless · Fashion Jewellery · Fine Jewellery - Gold Coins · Fine Jewellery - Studded · Fine Jewellery - Unstudded and Solitaire · Grocery & Gourmet - Oils · Grocery & Gourmet - Other Products · Grocery - Dried fruits and nuts · Grocery - Herbs and Spices · Grocery and Gourmet - Hampers and gifting ·

Health and Household - Household Cleaning, Laundry, Air Fresheners, Personal Hygiene (Handwash) · Health and Household - ayurvedic, homeopathic and alternate medicine products · Luggage - Other Products · Silver Coins and Bars · Silver Jewellery · Toys - Other Products · Toys - Party Supplies, Balloons, Banners, Masks, Confetti, Birthday Celebration · Wallets

What this means for your ₹333 rope wire

VERIFIED

Home - Other Products and **Home improvement - Other Products** both sit in **tier 1**. At ₹333 you are in the ₹301–500 band, so your closing fee is ₹18.

But confirm which category you are actually in. “Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)” sits in the **Standard tier at ₹22**, and also carries a 10% referral fee above ₹300. Being classified as Wires rather than Home costs about **₹37 more per sale before GST** — over ₹4,000 a month at 100 orders.

Appendix C · Amazon Terms Glossary

Roughly in the order a new seller meets them.

Term	What it means
ASIN	Amazon Standard Identification Number — the unique ID Amazon gives every product listing.
SKU	Stock Keeping Unit — <i>your</i> internal code for a product, which you map to an ASIN.
GTIN / UPC / EAN	Global product IDs issued by GS1. Needed for most new listings unless you get an exemption (19.1).
FNSKU	Amazon's own barcode for tracking FBA stock. Separate from GTIN.
Buy Box	The default “Add to Cart” offer when several sellers list the same product. FBA and good account health improve your odds. Losing it usually means losing most of the sales.
Brand Registry	Amazon's trademark-based protection programme. Unlocks A+ Content, Sponsored Brands, Brand Store, Vine, and protection against listing hijackers.
A+ Content	Enhanced listing content — extra images, comparison charts, brand story. Needs Brand Registry.
Brand Store	A free multi-page mini-site inside Amazon, for Brand Registered sellers.
Amazon Vine	Gives free products to trusted reviewers in exchange for honest reviews. The legitimate way to seed first reviews. Needs Brand Registry.
Sponsored Products / Brands / Display	Amazon's three ad formats — see Chapter 21.
Coupons / Lightning Deals / Subscribe & Save	Promotional tools. Each has its own eligibility rules and its own small fee.
IPI	Inventory Performance Index — a score measuring how well you manage FBA stock. A low score triggers storage limits.
AHR	Account Health Rating — a score for policy compliance and performance, built from your defect, cancellation, late shipment and tracking rates.
ODR	Order Defect Rate — share of orders with a negative review, A-to-Z claim or chargeback. Watch this one closely.
VTR	Valid Tracking Rate — share of shipments with valid, on-time tracking.
VOC	Voice of the Customer — a dashboard flagging listings with quality problems before they become policy violations.
RDR / NCX	Metrics for negative customer experiences tied to returns. A high rate can suppress a listing even without a formal violation.
SAFE-T	The claim process for recovering money when Amazon's own fulfilment causes a loss (20.4).
Restock Limits	Caps on how much stock you may send to FBA at once, tied to your IPI and sell-through.

Exact thresholds are deliberately not printed here

You will see specific numbers quoted: IPI below 400 triggers limits, ODR must stay under 1%, VTR above 95%, new sellers start at AHR 200. [CHECK LIVE](#) **Amazon changes these thresholds periodically** — the IPI cutoff in particular has moved more than once. Rather than print numbers that may already be stale, check **Seller Central → Performance → Account Health**, which shows your live targets.

Appendix D · Where to Look Things Up, and a Scorecard

Some data goes stale so fast that printing it would be irresponsible. Here is where to find it live instead.

What you need	Where to get it
HSN code for a product	CBIC's official HSN search, or your GST portal's lookup — cbic-gst.gov.in
Current GST rate for a category	CBIC rate finder — cbic-gst.gov.in . Rates are revised by the GST Council periodically.
Your exact fees for one product	Revenue Calculator and Fee Preview in Seller Central. Beats every table in this book.
Seasonal demand for your category	Google Trends for your product terms, cross-checked against the Indian festival calendar. A generic calendar is not specific enough to be useful.
Suppliers	IndiaMART / TradeIndia / Udaan search, filtered by category. A static supplier list goes stale the moment one stops replying.
Brand Registry requirements	Seller Central's own enrolment flow — it tells you what is missing for <i>your</i> application in real time.
Account health thresholds	Seller Central → Performance → Account Health

Product decision scorecard

Score each candidate 1 to 5 on every row, then compare totals. Maximum 40.

Factor	Score 1–5	Where to check
Demand — steady, not a spike	___	Chapter 15
Competition — is there room?	___	Chapter 15
Margin after <i>every</i> fee	___	Chapters 8 & 11
Compliance simplicity — fewer regulators scores higher	___	Chapters 16 & 17
Weight and size — lighter scores higher	___	Chapters 8.4 & 19
Capital needed vs what you have	___	Chapter 18
Return-rate risk for this category	___	Chapter 20
Fit with your existing catalogue and brand	___	Chapters 4 & 22
Total	___ / 40	

How to read your score

Below about 24, pass — however exciting the sales numbers look. A product that is cheap to buy but expensive to comply with, or high-margin but high-return, usually is not worth the operational load it adds. You only have so much attention, and your first profitable product deserves most of it.

Appendix E • Launch Checklist

Print one copy per product. If every box is ticked, you have touched every chapter that matters for a launch.

- ☐ Product passed the decision scorecard (Appendix D)
- ☐ Gating checked (Chapter 13)
- ☐ BIS / FSSAI / CDSCO / WPC / Hazmat checked against Chapter 17 — **not assumed**
- ☐ EPR plastic position confirmed (17.5) — do not assume exemption
- ☐ Trademark conflict search done for your brand name (16.3)
- ☐ Barcode ownership checked at verify.gs1.org if the supplier gave you a GTIN
- ☐ Supplier finalised — 3+ quotes compared, MOQ agreed, freight responsibility in writing
- ☐ Sample ordered, received and physically tested
- ☐ Packaging chosen and matched to product type (19.3)
- ☐ GTIN sourced, or exemption applied for (19.1)
- ☐ FNSKU label placement checked against labelling declarations (7.2, 19.2)
- ☐ Legal Metrology declarations confirmed on the package **and** the listing page
- ☐ **Fee category confirmed via Fee Preview** — the exact name written down
- ☐ **Closing fee read from Fee Preview**, not assumed from Appendix B
- ☐ Packed unit weighed and measured, then run through the Revenue Calculator
- ☐ Margin sheet completed (Chapter 11) — confirmed at least 20% net after all fees, GST included
- ☐ Listing created — title, bullets, backend keywords
- ☐ Images uploaded — all angles, main image on pure white background
- ☐ Inventory sent to FBA — **small test batch first**
- ☐ Request-a-Review automation turned on
- ☐ Advertising started — Automatic targeting first (21.2)
- ☐ Reviews monitored weekly for the first 4–6 weeks
- ☐ Account Health checked — ODR, Late Shipment Rate, Cancellation Rate
- ☐ Monthly reconciliation done — settlement report vs GST returns, TCS at **0.5%**

Appendix F • Fulfilment Centre Codes by State

Use this to spot when Amazon has moved your stock into a state where you may need a separate GST registration (5.2).

Read this before using the table

UNCONFIRMED This list comes from an FC capabilities sheet that could not be independently verified against a published Amazon document.

Never register for GST in a state based on this table alone. Amazon opens new centres and reassigns codes. Always open the **full address** shown against the FC code in Seller Central first. Registering in the wrong state is far more expensive than registering late.

State	Cities	FC codes reported
Telangana (yours)	Hyderabad	HYD3, HYD8, SHYL, SHTX, SHYH, SHTI, XSAD, XSIP
Haryana	Gurgaon, Gurugram, Jhajjar	DEL2, DEL4, DEL5, DED4, SHDZ, HDX1, HDO3, SDEU, LDX1, XNAB
Delhi (NCT)	New Delhi	DEX3, DEX8
Punjab	Ludhiana, Rajpura	ATX1, SATF
Rajasthan	Jaipur, Bagru	JPX1, JPX2
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	LKO1, SLKY, SLKF
Maharashtra	Mumbai, Bhiwandi, Pune, Nagpur	BOM4, BOM5, BOM7, PNQ3, NAX1, SBOW, SPUN, SBOB, XWUA
Gujarat	Ahmedabad, Kheda	AMD2, SAME
West Bengal	Howrah, Kolkata, Serampore, Islampur	CCX1, CCX2, CCX4, SCCX, SCCE, SCUY
Assam	Guwahati, Changsari	GAX1, SGAC
Bihar	Patna	PAX, SPAB
Odisha	Bhubaneswar	BBX1
Karnataka	Bangalore, Hubballi	BLR5, BLR7, BLR8, SBLU, SBLL, BLX1, SBLB
Tamil Nadu	Chennai, Coimbatore, Karumathampatti, Tiruvallur, Krishnagiri	MAA4, SMAB, SMAH, CJB1, SCJY, SCJF, SBLI, SCJB
Andhra Pradesh	Visakhapatnam, Anakapalli	RJX1, SVTZ
Kerala	Ernakulam	COX1
Madhya Pradesh	Indore, Bhopal	IDX2, SBHF

Two traps in the code names

- **DEL does not mean Delhi.** DEL2, DEL4, DEL5 and the DED codes are physically in Gurgaon/Gurugram — **Haryana**. Genuine Delhi centres use **DEX**.
- **Some Bangalore-sounding codes are in Tamil Nadu.** SBLI and SCJB are at Krishnagiri, just across the Tamil Nadu border.
- **LDX1 is ambiguous** in the source sheet — grouped with Haryana, but Rajpura itself is in Punjab. If you see LDX1, check the full address.

Heavy & Bulky facilities

UNCONFIRMED There are reportedly 16 dedicated Heavy & Bulky centres nationwide, with maximum unit height of 3 metres and tiered truck-loading limits (85 kg on the floor level, 44 kg stacked above). Relevant only if you move into furniture or appliances.

Appendix G · Seller Central Navigation

What each menu does. Not a screenshot guide — Amazon rearranges the interface, and a picture would be stale within months.

Menu	What lives there	Chapter
Catalogue	Add Products, Manage Inventory, Add via Upload, Listing Limitations (category approval)	13, 16, 19
Inventory	Manage FBA Inventory, Manage FBA Shipments, Restock, Inventory Age report	8.6, 20
Pricing	Manage Pricing, Automate Pricing, Fee Preview per listing	8, 11
Orders	Manage Orders, Manage Returns, SAFE-T claims	20
Advertising	Campaign Manager, A+ Content Manager, Stores, deals and coupons	21, 22
Growth	STEP programme, Global Selling, deals calendar	24.5, 25
Reports	Payments and settlement reports, Business Reports, Inventory Ledger , Tax Document Library	3.1, 5.4
Performance	Account Health, Voice of the Customer, Feedback	App. C
Services	Service Provider Network (paid third-party help)	—

G.1 The four tools you will actually use every month

Tool	What it is for
Fee Preview Pricing, or inside Manage Inventory	Shows the real current fees for one specific product. This settles every disagreement with this book.
Revenue Calculator Reports / search “calculator”	Enter a price, weight and dimensions to see the full fee breakdown, FBA vs self-ship side by side. The only way to get your weight handling fee.
Inventory Ledger Reports → Inventory Ledger	Shows which fulfilment centres hold your stock. Your monthly GST safety check (5.2).
Transaction View Reports → Payments	Every order, refund and fee, line by line. This is what you reconcile against your GST returns — and where you find your TCS lines.

CHECK LIVE A note on payouts: money showing as “posted” can still be held under Amazon's reserve policy. If a deposit looks small, check reserves and pending refunds in Transaction View before assuming an error.

G.2 Creating a listing

Two routes:

- **The product already exists on Amazon:** search by title, UPC/EAN or ASIN, click “Sell Yours”, then add your price, quantity, condition and fulfilment channel.
- **It does not exist:** choose “I’m adding a product not sold on Amazon” and build a full listing.

UNCONFIRMED A new listing needs: Title, Brand, Bullet points, Description, Images, backend search terms, Category and Price. **MRP is mandatory for every category except Books.** Gated categories need documents uploaded during listing — typically an invoice, the category licence, and all-sided packaging images.

G.3 Main image rules — the most common reason listings get suppressed

UNCONFIRMED Cross-checked across several 2026 seller resources. **CHECK LIVE** Confirm against Amazon's own image requirements page before a photoshoot.

Requirement	Specification
Background (main image only)	Pure white — RGB 255,255,255 exactly. Not off-white, not cream.
Product fills the frame	85% or more
Minimum size	1,000 px on the longest side — zoom only activates at this point
Practical working size	1,600–2,000 px+ on the longest side
Maximum	10,000 px longest side, 10 MB file size
Formats	JPEG preferred; PNG, TIFF, non-animated GIF accepted
Text, logos, badges, watermarks	Not allowed on the main image. Fine on images 2–9.
Props, hands, accessories	Not allowed on the main image — just the product

Use images 2 to 9 properly. They are far more flexible: lifestyle shots, infographics with feature callouts, size comparisons, close-up details. Most sellers leave these empty, which is free ground given away.

Some categories add rules on top — footwear needs a single shoe at 45 degrees facing left; apparel needs on-model or flat-lay, not a mannequin. Check your category before shooting.

Appendix H · What to Confirm in Your Own Account

The fee tables in this book are verified. Your listing has been checked. What remains are items specific to you — and one of them is urgent.

0 · Add your fulfilment centre to your GST certificate — DO THIS FIRST

Your REG-06 certificate declares **zero additional places of business**, while your stock sits in an Amazon fulfilment centre in Telangana. Amazon itself requires the FC to be declared as an Additional Place of Business.

Full instructions are in section 5.5. Check the current certificate first — if you already amended it, you are fine. Same state, so an amendment is enough; no new GSTIN, no VPOB. Also confirm GSTR-1 and GSTR-3B are filed for June and July 2026.

Already settled — no action needed

Verified from Amazon's own rate cards and your live listing: the whole closing-fee table, the weight-handling rate card, all 219 referral categories, pick & pack, storage, removal, GST treatment, the STEP benefits table, and your listing's brand field (**Generic**), price, category path and fulfilment method.

1 · Your fee category DO THIS FIRST

Where: Seller Central → Manage Inventory → your rope wire SKU → Fee Preview.

What to read: the exact *fee category* name.

Why it matters more than anything else on this list. If it says a Home category you pay **₹0 referral + ₹18 closing**. If it says “Wires (Electrical Wires/cables for house wiring, ad hoc usage)” you pay **₹33.30 referral + ₹22 closing** — about **₹44 more per sale including GST**, or ₹4,400 a month at 100 orders. Same product, same price, different classification.

If it is classified as Wires and the product is genuinely a non-electrical clothesline, that is worth raising with Seller Support as a catalogue classification correction.

2 · Your packed weight

What to do: weigh and measure the finished parcel, not the rope.

Why: the 500 g line is worth ₹15 per Regional order and ₹20 per National order (8.4). Also check volumetric weight — $\text{length} \times \text{breadth} \times \text{height} \div 5000$ — because a large light box is billed on its size, not its weight.

3 · Your STEP level and its metrics

Where: the STEP dashboard in Seller Central.

You are on **Standard**, which is what the rates in Chapter 8 assume. Confirm it, then look at the return-rate metric — on FBA that is your main lever for reaching Advanced (8.9). Evaluation is quarterly, so acting early in a quarter is worth more than acting late.

4 · Which fulfilment centres hold your stock

Where: Reports → Inventory Ledger → Summary view + Fulfilment centre + Last 30 days.

Look for any centre outside Telangana. If one appears with a positive balance, that is a potential GST registration obligation in that state (5.2). **This is a monthly check**, because Amazon redistributes stock without telling you. Always confirm the state from the full address, never from the code prefix.

5 · Your account health thresholds

Where: Performance → Account Health.

Read your live targets for Order Defect Rate, Late Shipment Rate, Cancellation Rate and IPI rather than relying on figures quoted in any guide — Amazon adjusts them.

6 · Two open questions worth professional advice

Question	Who to ask
EPR plastic packaging — are you exempt as a micro/small brand owner? (17.5)	CPCB directly, or an environmental compliance consultant. Sources genuinely conflict, so do not rely on either answer you find online.
Income tax — presumptive taxation under 44AD versus normal books, advance tax dates, and which return to file (Chapter 6)	A CA. One consultation is cheap next to a penalty, and the Income Tax Act, 2025 changed some mechanics.

The half-hour that pays for itself

Items 1 to 3 take about thirty minutes together, and they convert Chapter 9 from a range into an exact figure. Item 1 alone could be worth ₹4,400 a month. Start there.

Appendix I · Official Links

What for	Where
Amazon fees — the source for this book	sell.amazon.in/fees-and-pricing
Seller Central — daily dashboard	sellercentral.amazon.in
Inventory Ledger (monthly GST check)	Seller Central → Reports → Inventory Ledger
Revenue Calculator / Fee Preview	Inside Seller Central — see Appendix G.1
Fee announcements	Seller Central → Announcements
Restricted Products policy	Seller Central → Help → search “Restricted Products”
Check who else sells on your ASIN	amazon.in/gp/offer-listing/[your ASIN]
Seller University (video guides)	Seller Central → Help
GST portal	gst.gov.in
GST rates and HSN lookup	cbic-gst.gov.in
Income tax	incometaxindia.gov.in
Trademark search and filing (TM-A)	ipindiaonline.gov.in
Barcode ownership lookup	verify.gs1.org
BIS (product certification, hallmarking)	bis.gov.in
FSSAI (food licences)	foscos.fssai.gov.in
CDSCO (medical devices)	cdsco.gov.in
WPC ETA self-declaration	saralsanchar.gov.in
EPR plastic packaging	eprplastic.cpcb.gov.in
EPR batteries	eprbattery.cpcb.gov.in
DGFT (import export code)	dgft.gov.in
Legal Metrology Act	consumeraffairs.gov.in
Cyber crime (fraud reporting)	cybercrime.gov.in · helpline 1930

Closing Note — How to Keep This Current

This book is a map, not a live feed. It tells you what to look for and where. The number on Amazon's or a regulator's own page always beats the number here.

Before you source or reprice anything

1. **Re-read the referral and closing fee** for that exact fee category — Appendix A/B, then confirm in Fee Preview.
2. **Run the product through the Revenue Calculator** for the weight-dependent fees.
3. **Re-check gating** (Chapter 13) — it changes.
4. **Re-check the regulator list** (Chapter 17). Thresholds shift, as FSSAI showed on 1 April 2026 with no warning.
5. **Confirm your packaging still meets the labelling rules** (Chapter 7).

What to re-verify, and when

Item	How often
Which fulfilment centres hold your stock	Monthly — this is the one that creates legal exposure
TCS credit matching on the GST portal	Monthly
Account Health metrics	Weekly
Referral and closing fee tables	Every 6 months, or on any announcement
Compliance rules for your categories	Before every new product
Aged-inventory threshold	Before planning any bulk order

Why the labels matter more than the numbers

The most dangerous thing in a reference document is a confident label standing in for an actual check — because once something reads as “confirmed”, nobody looks at it again. That is how an out-of-date TCS rate or a phantom “no closing fee above ₹500” survives for years and gets copied between guides.

So treat the labels here as instructions, not decoration. **VERIFIED** means a named source was read and linked. **UNCONFIRMED** means it is probably right but nobody checked it for this edition. **CHECK LIVE** means only you can see it. **UNSETTLED** means credible sources disagree and you should get advice.

Three things to do this week: open Fee Preview and read your exact fee category, weigh the packed coil, and confirm your STEP level. Under an hour in total, and it turns the rest of this book into your actual numbers.